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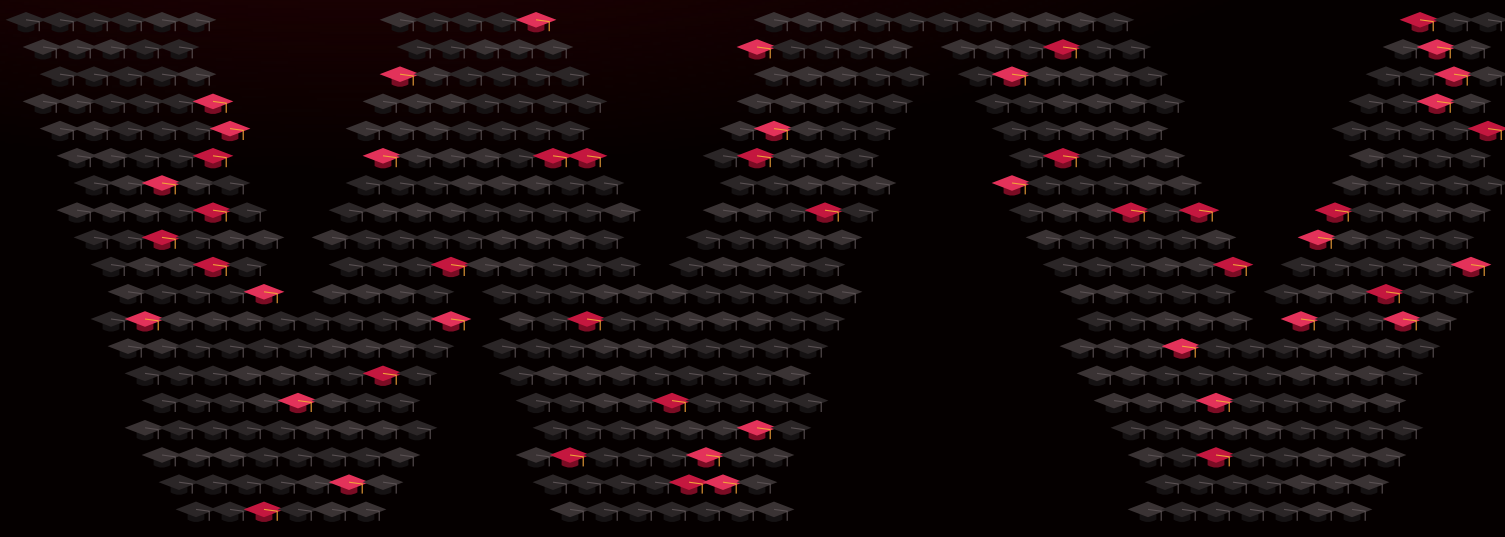
NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 West Virginia Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston

Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **10 in every 100**, mark the international share of West Virginia's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 West Virginia Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to West Virginia: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 West Virginia Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What West Virginia's numbers say

1. **International students earn 10% of West Virginia's STEM master's degrees,** 41.9 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 48th of 51 on dependence. The share is 43% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 3.4% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **West Virginia awarded 76 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.1% of the U.S. total and 45th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed −43%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 33% of master's degrees (84 degrees; U.S. 49%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** West Virginia ranks 5th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: West Virginia 10%, Idaho 18%, Nebraska 25%, Nevada 30%, Arkansas 65%.
5. **58% of West Virginia's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 1.9% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (6.33K) than residents left (2.23K), a net gain of 4.1K; the top destination for those leaving was Ohio.

10%

of the STEM master's degrees West Virginia awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

WEST VIRGINIA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

137K #37
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −9.3% since 2015

76 #45
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · −43% since 2015

10% #48
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −13.1 pp since 2015

4.8% #49
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −1.6 pp since 2015

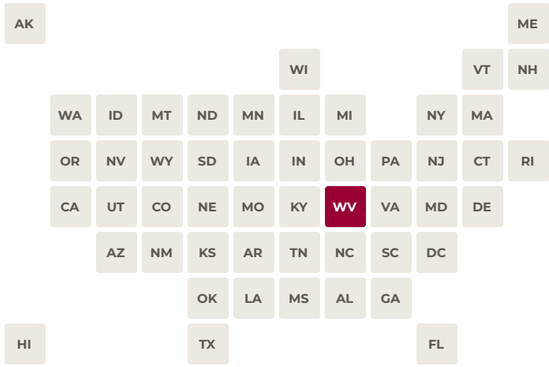
16% #50
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · −0.5 pp since 2015

53% #48
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +7.8 pp since 2015

$10.3K #31
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +36% since 2015

58% #44
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −2.9 pp since 2016

$76.4K #49
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −9.4% since 2016



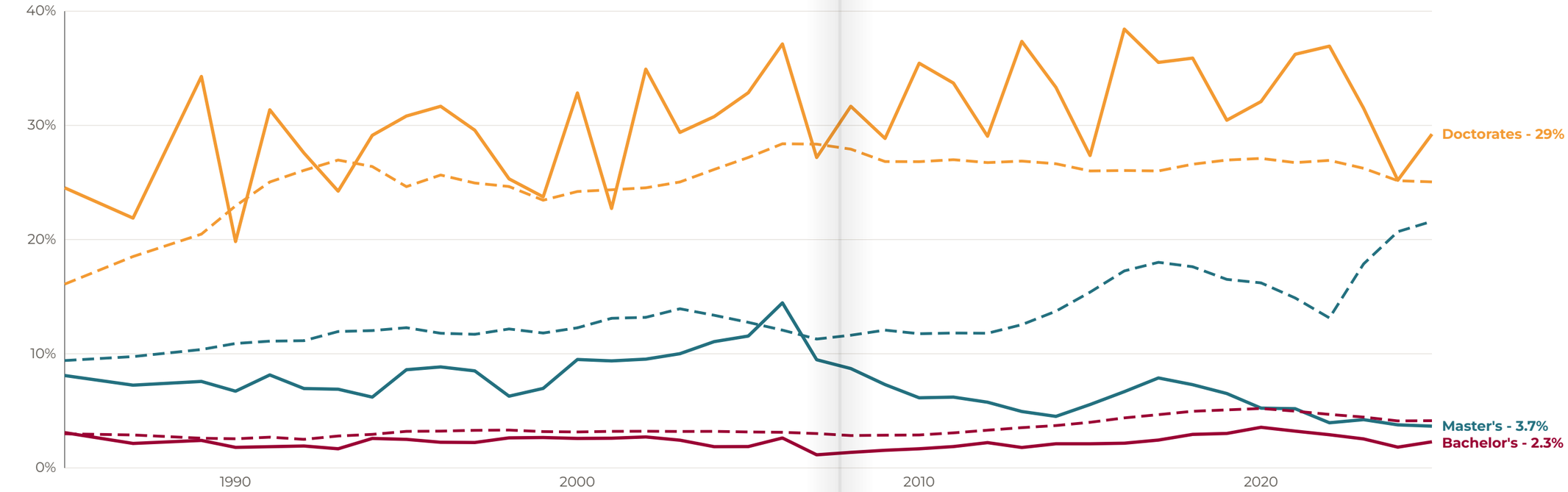
Badges give West Virginia's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on the international share of all master's, at 3.7% in 2025 against 22% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of West Virginia's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 4.8% of West Virginia's graduate enrollment and 1.7% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 2.3% of bachelor's, 3.7% of master's and 29% of research doctorates go to international students.

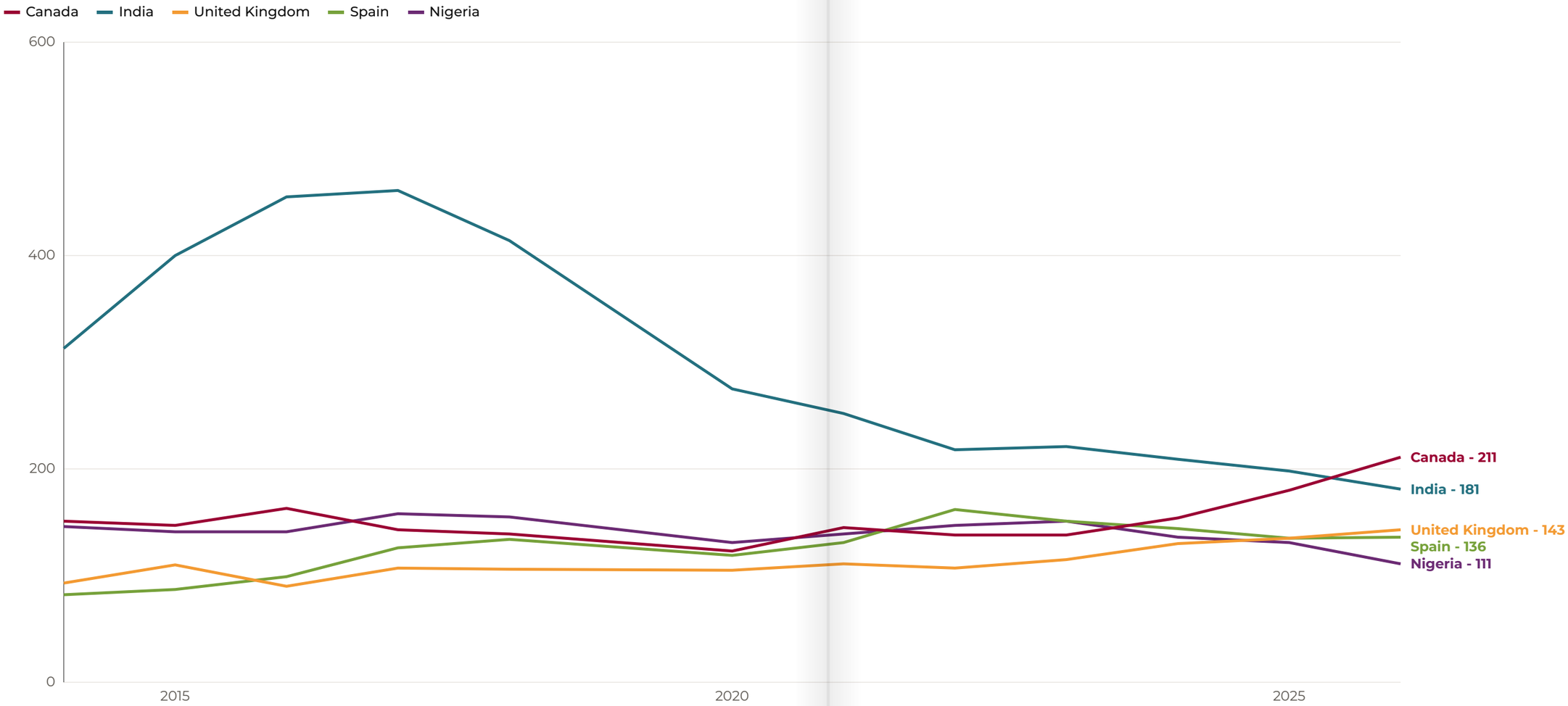
In STEM the shares are higher still: 3.4% of STEM bachelor's, 10% of STEM master's and 43% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.1% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 45th of 51.

4.8%
Int. share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · **49th** of 51 · −1.6 pp since 2015

3.7%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **50th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2015

10%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **48th** of 51 · −13.1 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do West Virginia's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, West Virginia had 2.48K active international students in SEVIS, 45th of 51. Canada accounted for 8.5% of them and India for 7.3%, against 3.3% and 27% nationally.

Students came from 138 countries, but the two largest supplied 16%. The state's total is down 39% since 2014.

2.48K
Active international students, October 2026
45th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

8.5%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

41%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

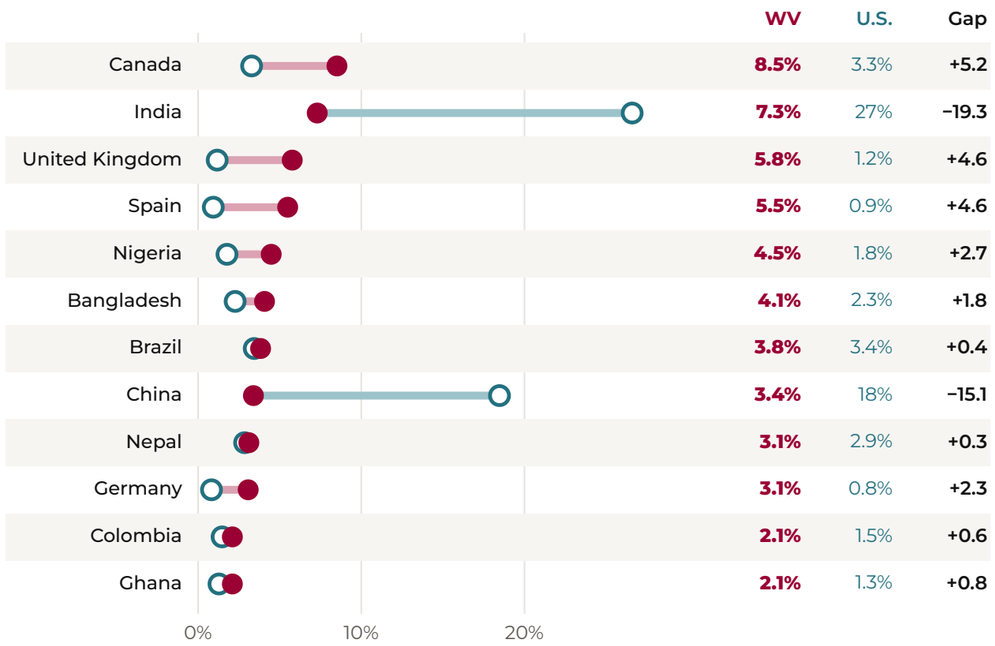
How Does West Virginia's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, West Virginia had **2.48K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 45th of 51 states and **0.2%** of the U.S. total. They came from 138 countries.

Canada supplied **8.5%** of them, against 3.3% nationally, and India **7.3%**, against 27%. The United Kingdom (5.8%), Spain (5.5%), and Nigeria (4.5%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **16%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 51st among the states, against 32% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is West Virginia's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

2.48K
Active international students, October 2026
45th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

8.5%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

7.3%
From India
U.S. **27%**

138
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 1.1% from 2025 and down 42% since 2015, when it stood at 4.26K. Its share of all U.S. international students is down 0.1 points since 2015, to **0.2%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Canada went from 147 to 211, India's from 400 to 181, and the United Kingdom's from 110 to 143.

Table 1 International Students in West Virginia, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	4.26K	2.51K	**2.48K**	−42%	1.19M	45th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	0.2%	**0.2%**	−0.1 pp	–	45th
Countries of citizenship represented	146	142	**138**	−5.5%	219	42nd
Share from the two largest countries of origin	32%	15%	**16%**	−16.7 pp	45%	51st
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Canada	147	180	**211**	+44%	3.3%	8.5%
India	400	198	**181**	−55%	27%	7.3%
United Kingdom	110	135	**143**	+30%	1.2%	5.8%
Spain	87	135	**136**	+56%	0.9%	5.5%
Nigeria	141	131	**111**	−21%	1.8%	4.5%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply West Virginia's International STEM Students?

1.01K of West Virginia's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **41%** of the total against 63% nationally, down 48% since 2015.

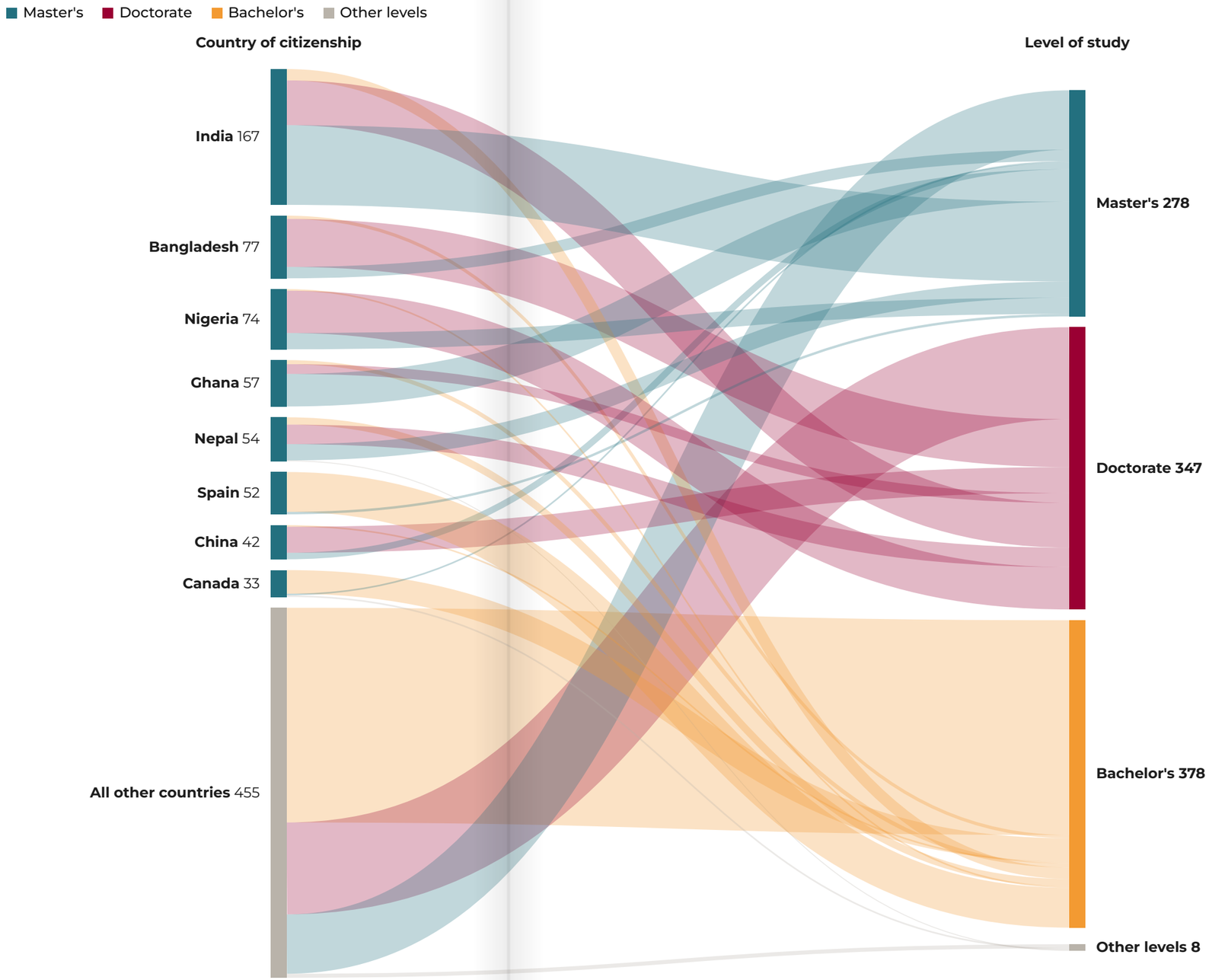
Bachelor's students were the largest group, **378**. Spain supplied 13% of them and Canada 7.7%.

STEM doctoral students went from 407 in 2015 to **347**, and STEM master's students from 429 to 278.

1.01K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **46th** of 51 · −48% since 2015

41%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

278
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **46th** of 51 · −35% since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. DHS does not draw its STEM pages on the same basis as its all-student pages, so the STEM count here exceeds the all-level count for Ghana (57 against 52). Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

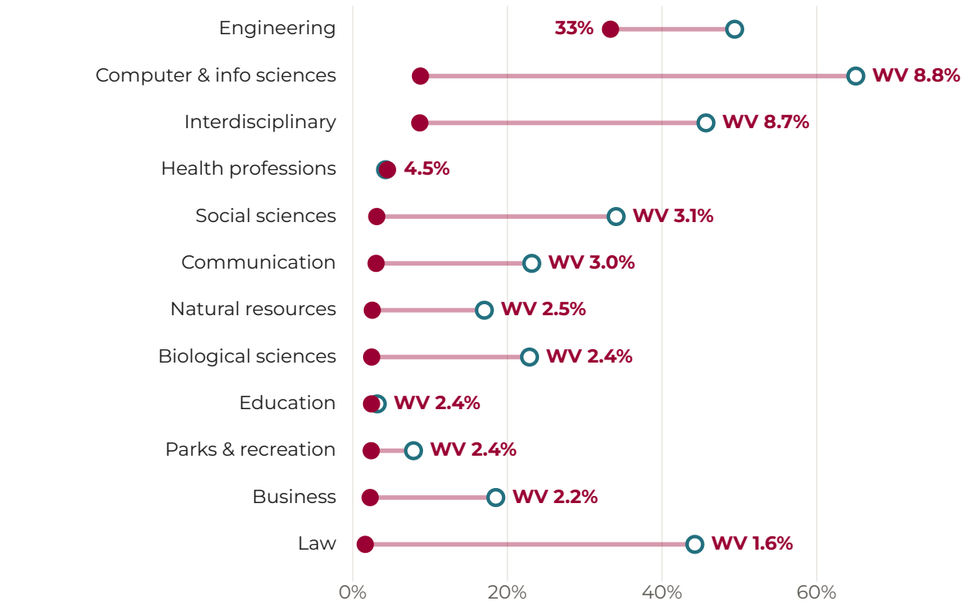
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are West Virginia's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in West Virginia in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in engineering (33%, against 49% for the U.S.), computer & info sciences (8.8%, against 65% for the U.S.), and interdisciplinary (8.7%, against 46% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

3.7%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **50th** of 51

10%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **48th** of 51

8.8%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **45th** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: West Virginia first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 33% of the master's degrees in engineering, against 49% for the U.S.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	3.6% / 8.6%	**8.8% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	6.2% / 7.2%	**33% / 49%**	64% / 55%
Engineering technology	0.6% / 4.5%	**0.0% / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	4.3% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	1.7% / 6.0%	**38% / 33%**	46% / 38%
Biological sciences	4.0% / 3.4%	**2.4% / 23%**	22% / 23%
Natural resources	0.4% / 2.0%	**2.5% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	– / 7.3%	**– / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in West Virginia / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

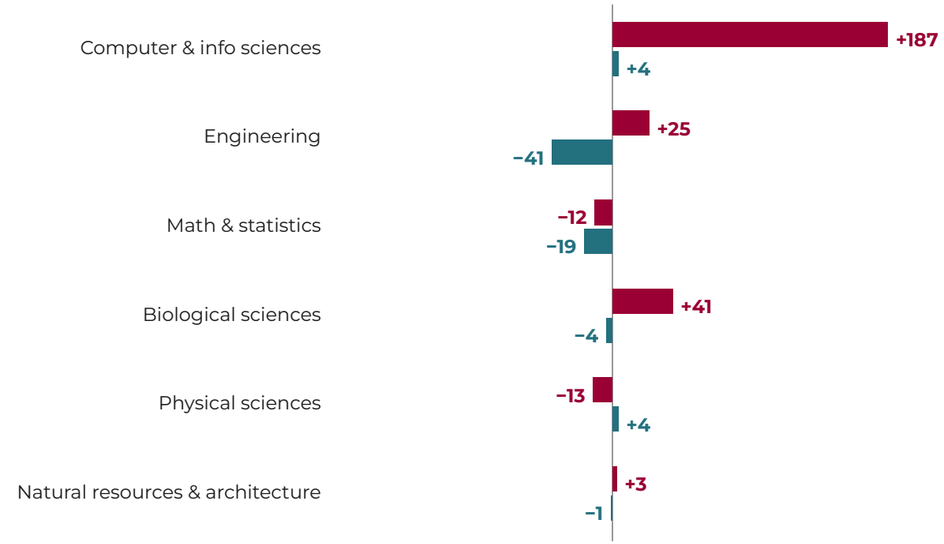
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has West Virginia's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in West Virginia between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 743 in 2025 and 569 in 2015, a change of −57 for international students and +231 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

76
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **45th** of 51

10%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **49th** of 51

0.1%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
45th of 51

6.4
STEM master's per doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **20th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in West Virginia in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 10% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 49th among the states, down 0.7 points from 11% in 2024 and up 1.5 points since 2015, when it was 8.7%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	129	**320**	+148%	28	19%	8.8%
Engineering	199	**183**	−8.0%	28	35%	15%
Math & statistics	43	**12**	–	6	58%	–
Biological sciences	45	**82**	–	2	13%	2.4%
Physical sciences	33	**24**	–	9	15%	–
Natural resources & architecture	120	**122**	+1.7%	3	3.3%	2.5%

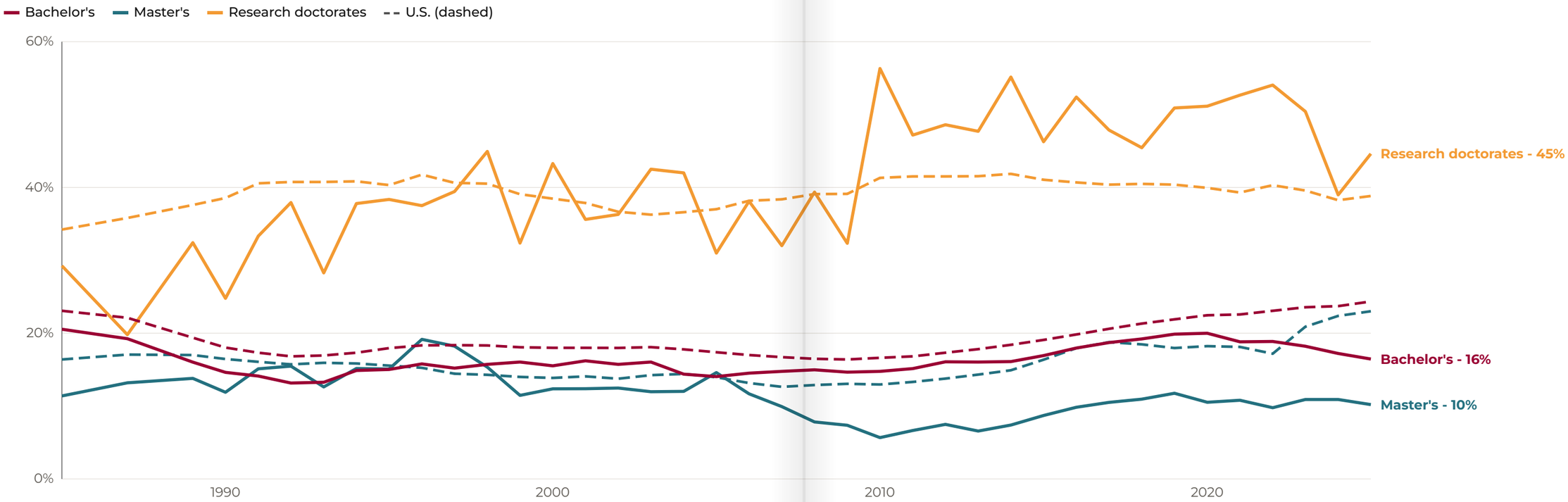
STEM master's degrees awarded in West Virginia, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on the STEM share of bachelor's, at 16% in 2025 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of West Virginia's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 16% of West Virginia's bachelor's degrees, 10% of its master's and 45% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 1.5 points since 2015, and the state ranks 49th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 50th of 51.

16%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **50th** of 51 · −0.5 pp since 2015

10%

STEM share of master's, 2025

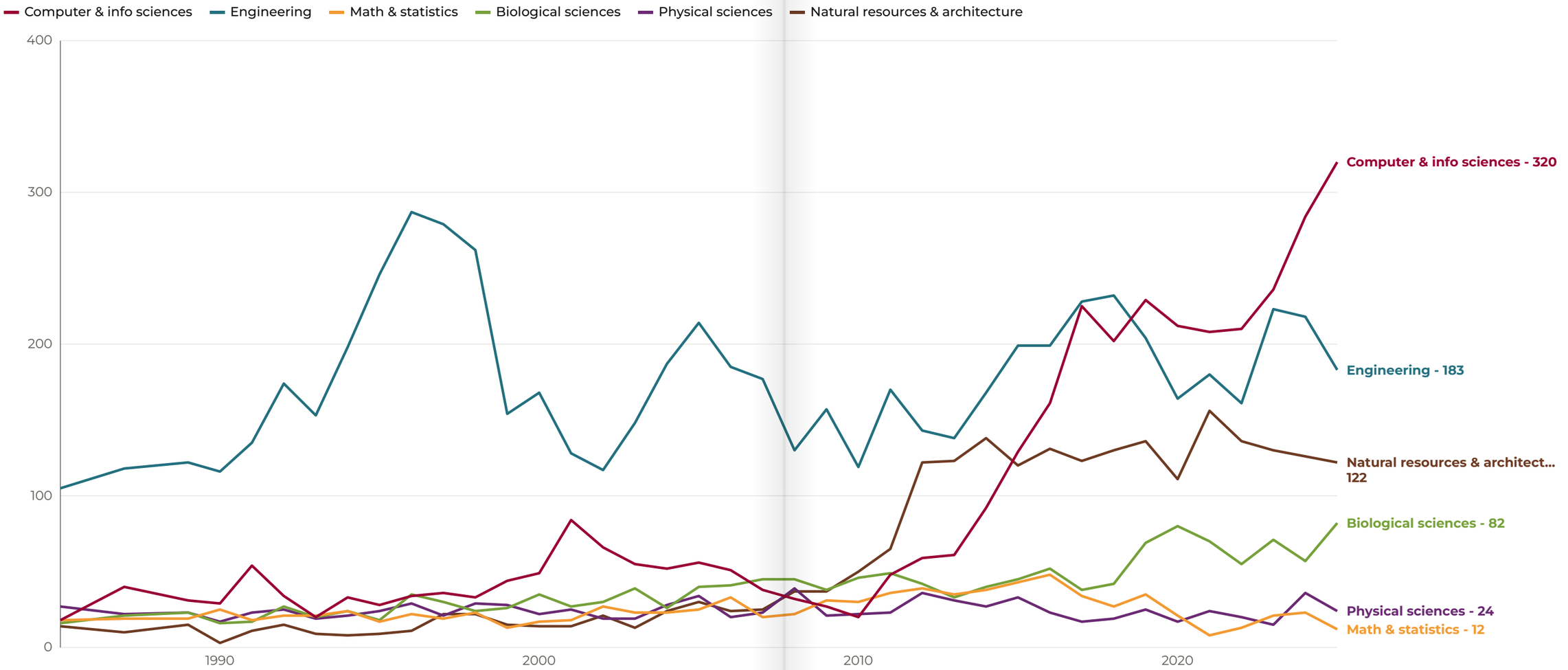
U.S. **23%** · **49th** of 51 · +1.5 pp since 2015

45%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **22nd** of 51 · −1.7 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce West Virginia's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 320, followed by engineering (183) and natural resources & architecture (122). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 148% since 2015.

International students earned 76 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.1% of the national total (45th of 51).

76

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **45th** of 51 · −43% since 2015

0.1%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

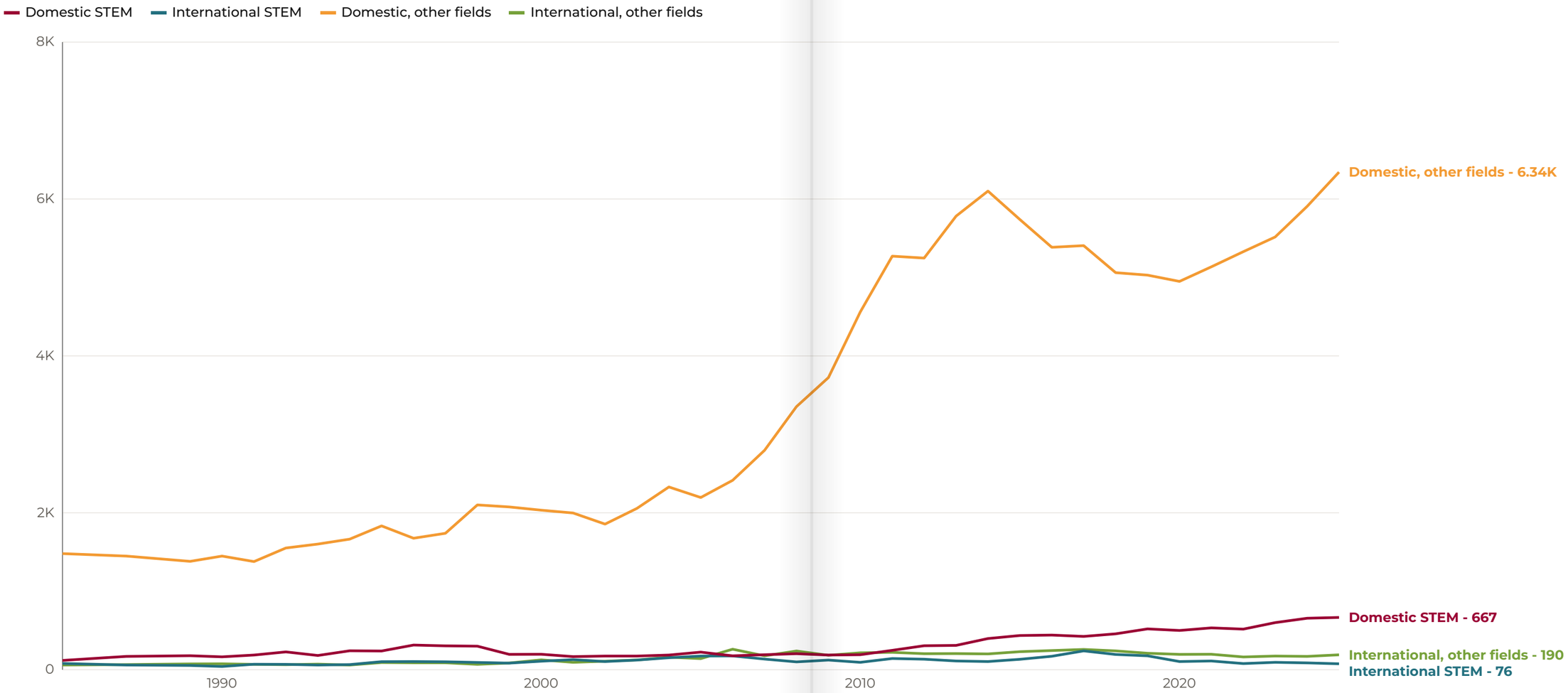
· **45th** of 51 · −0.2 pp since 2015

8.8%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **45th** of 47 · −9.9 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns West Virginia's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, −57 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 231 more to domestic students.

International students earn 10% of West Virginia's STEM master's but 2.9% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

3.7%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **50th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2015

10%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **48th** of 51 · −13.1 pp since 2015

6.4

STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

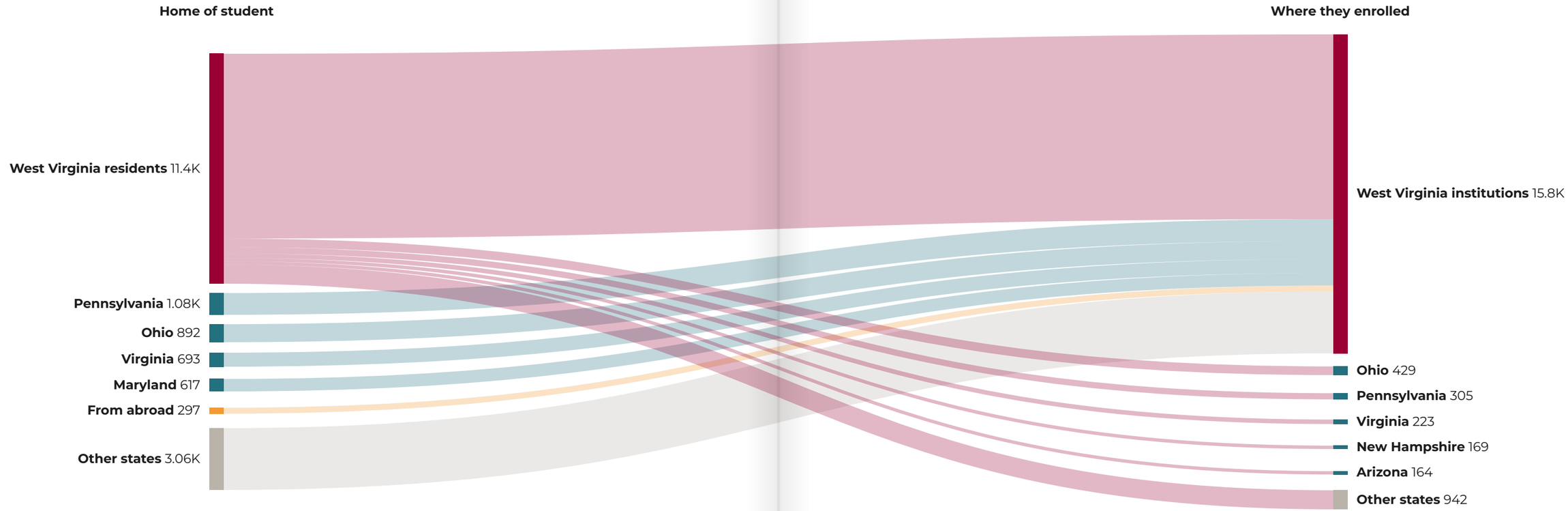
U.S. **6.4** · **20th** of 51 · +0.3 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

West Virginia ranks 7th of 51 states on net student migration, at +36 in 2024.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

9.14K residents stayed in West Virginia for college in fall 2024; 6.33K students arrived from other states and 297 from abroad, while 2.23K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 58% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

58%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **44th** of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2016

1.9%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

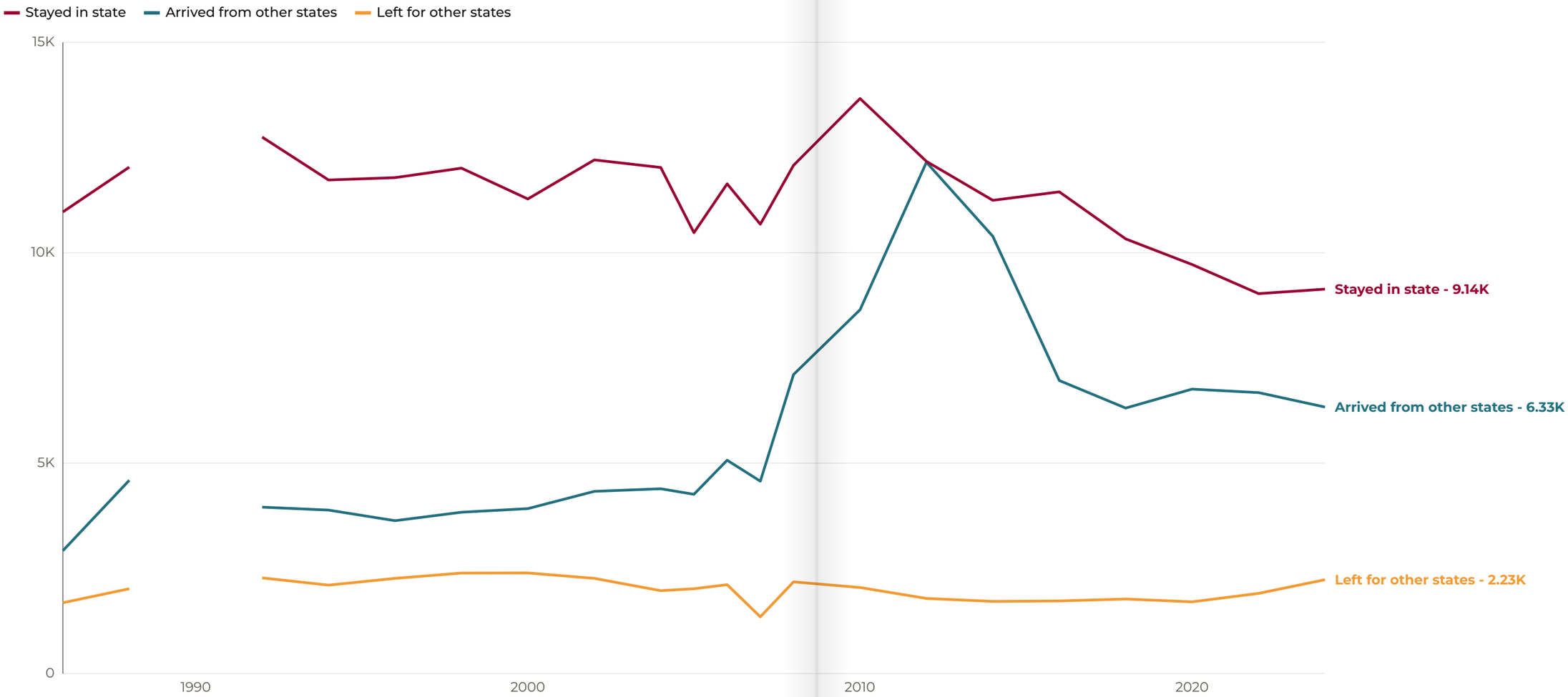
U.S. **3.1%** · **36th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2016

+36

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

· **7th** of 51 · −3.7 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 20%, arrivals from other states are down 9%, and residents leaving are up 29%.

Net migration was +36 per 100 resident first-time students (7th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Ohio (429).

Figure 12

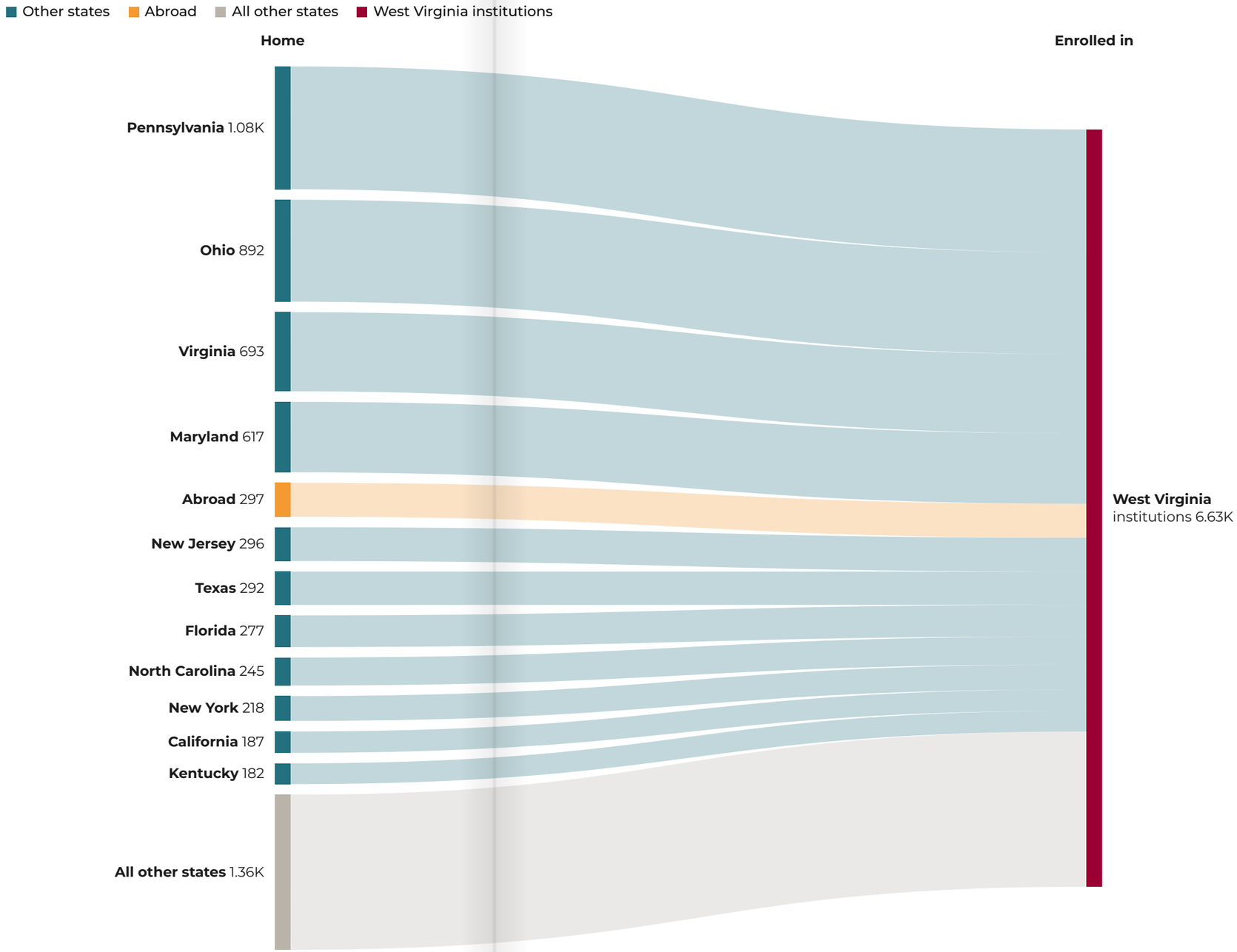
Where Do West Virginia's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at West Virginia's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

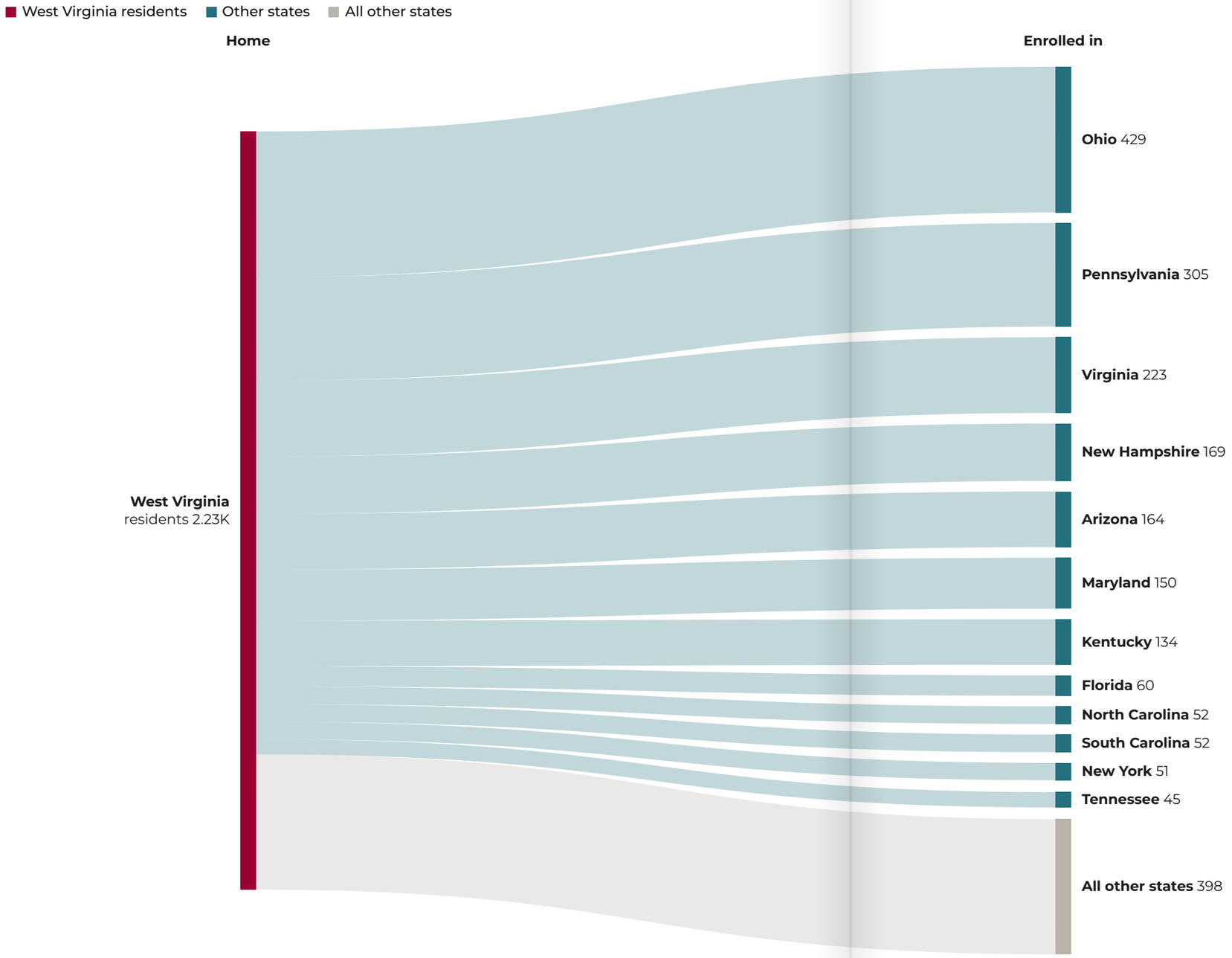
6.63K
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **297**

1.9%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **36th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2016

58%
First-time students from in state, 2024
44th of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do West Virginia's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where West Virginia residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 2.23K in fall 2024, up 17% from 1.91K in fall 2022 and up 29% since fall 2016, when it was 1.73K.

2.23K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrivals **6.63K**

+36
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
7th of 51 · −3.7 since 2016

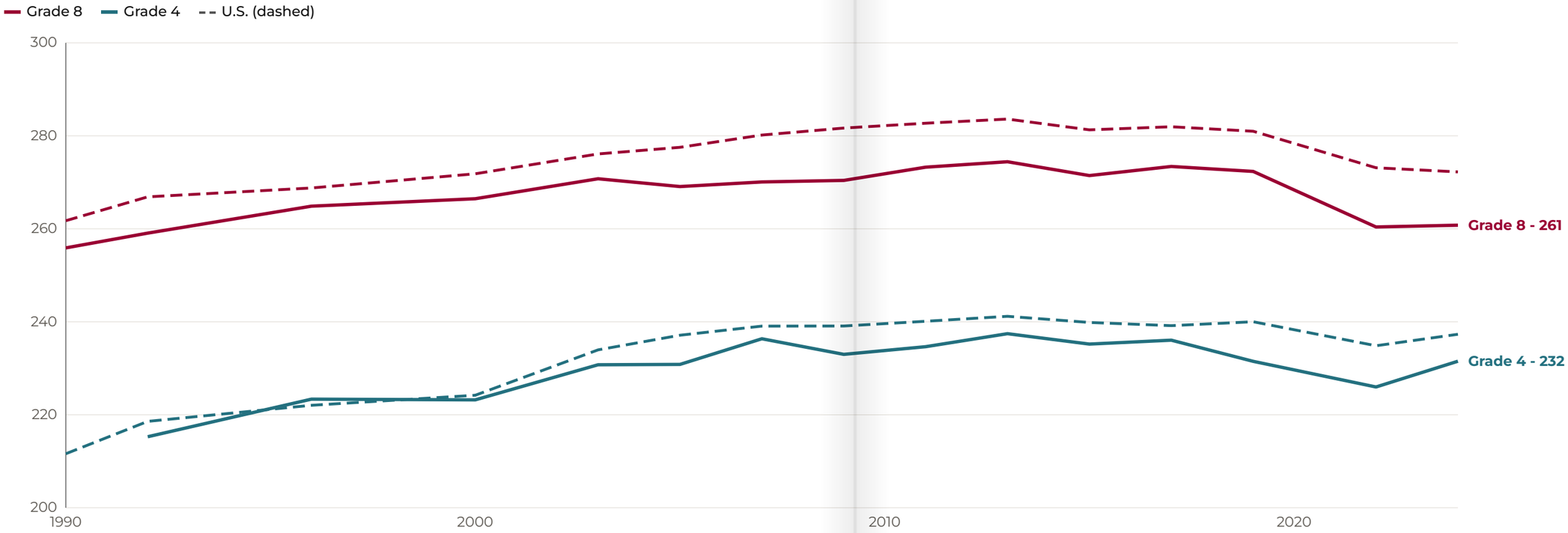
429
Went to Ohio
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 261 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are West Virginia's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. West Virginia's eighth graders averaged 261 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 50th of 51 among the states.

18% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

261

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **50th** of 51 · −10.7 since 2015

18%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **49th** of 51 · −2.8 pp since 2015

247

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

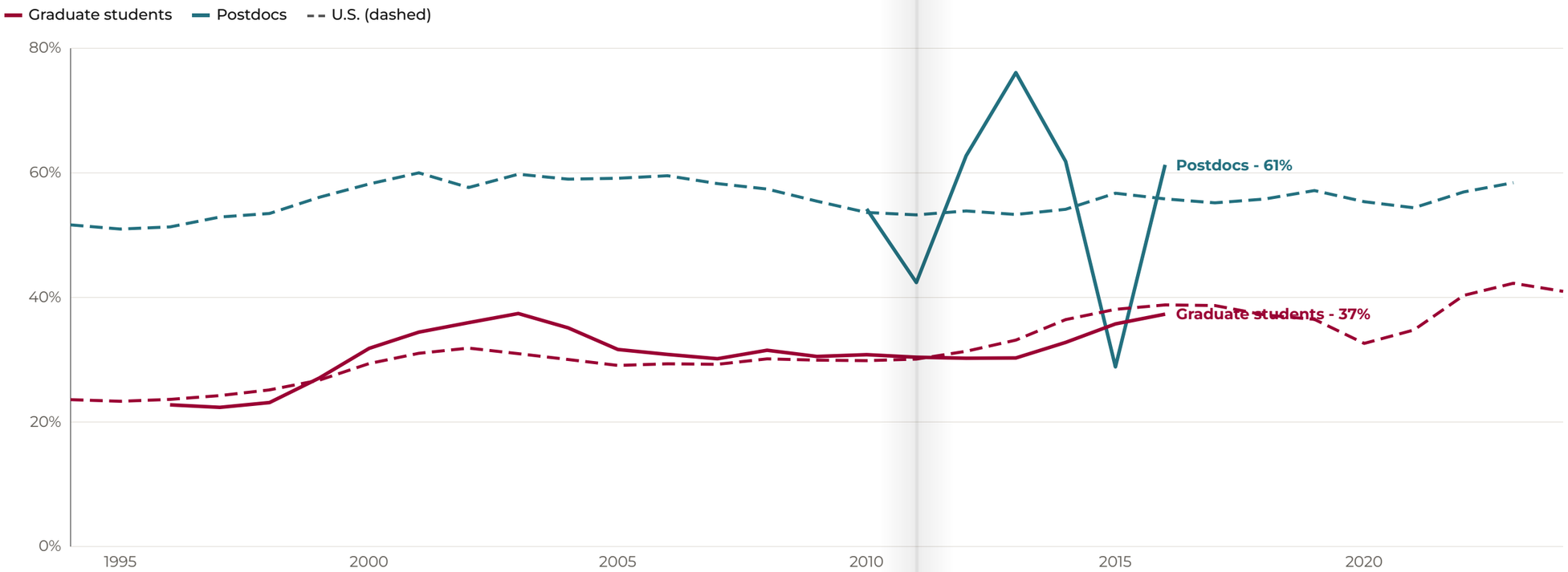
U.S. **257** · **49th** of 51 · −12.8 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

West Virginia ranks 41st of 51 states on research doctorates awarded, at 231 in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of West Virginia's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 37% of West Virginia's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 19th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 61% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 231 research doctorates in 2025, 0.4% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

37%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **19th** of 51 · +1.6 pp since 2015

61%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **13th** of 51 · +32.4 pp since 2015

231
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **41st** of 51 · +6.5% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

West Virginia ranks 30th of 33 states on the share of bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating, at 50% in 2019 against 72% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of West Virginia's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of West Virginia's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 50% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 39%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 20% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state gained 10.2 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

50%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **30th** of 33 · +1.0 pp since 2016

20%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **47th** of 51 · −0.7 pp since 2015

+10.2

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

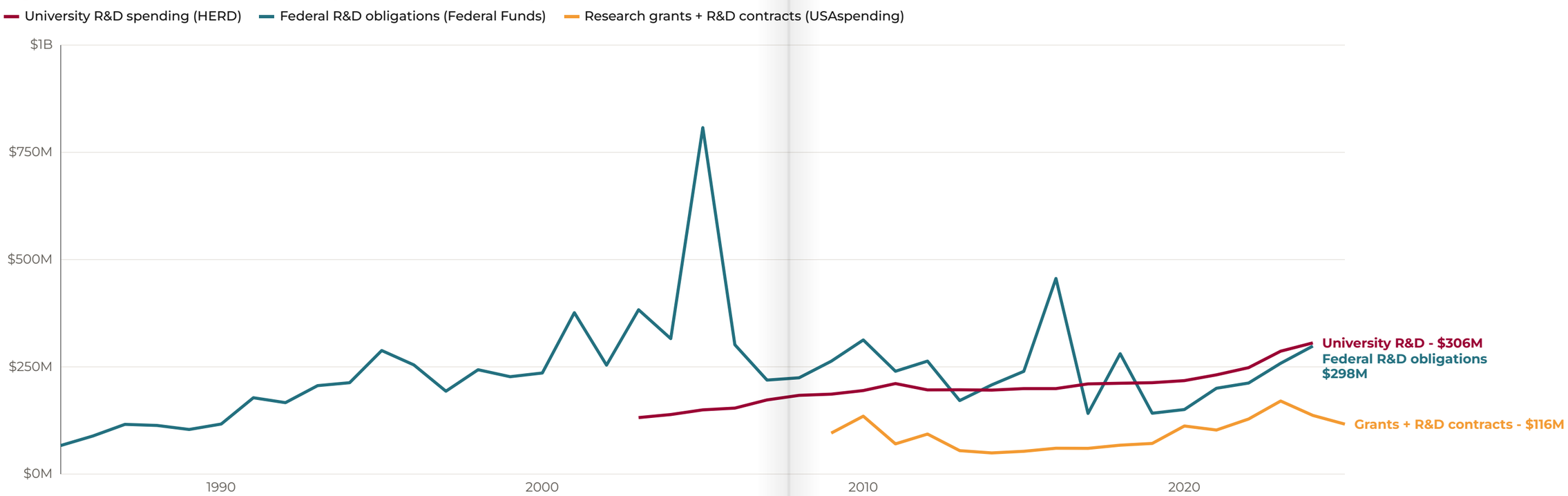
· **5th** of 51 · +29.6 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

West Virginia ranks 45th of 51 states on university R&D spending, at $306M in 2024 against $118B for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into West Virginia?



Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

West Virginia's universities spent $306M on research and development in FY2024, 45th of 51 among the states; 51% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $298M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$306M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **45th** of 51 · +54% since 2015

51%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **31st** of 51 · +7.3 pp since 2015

$298M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

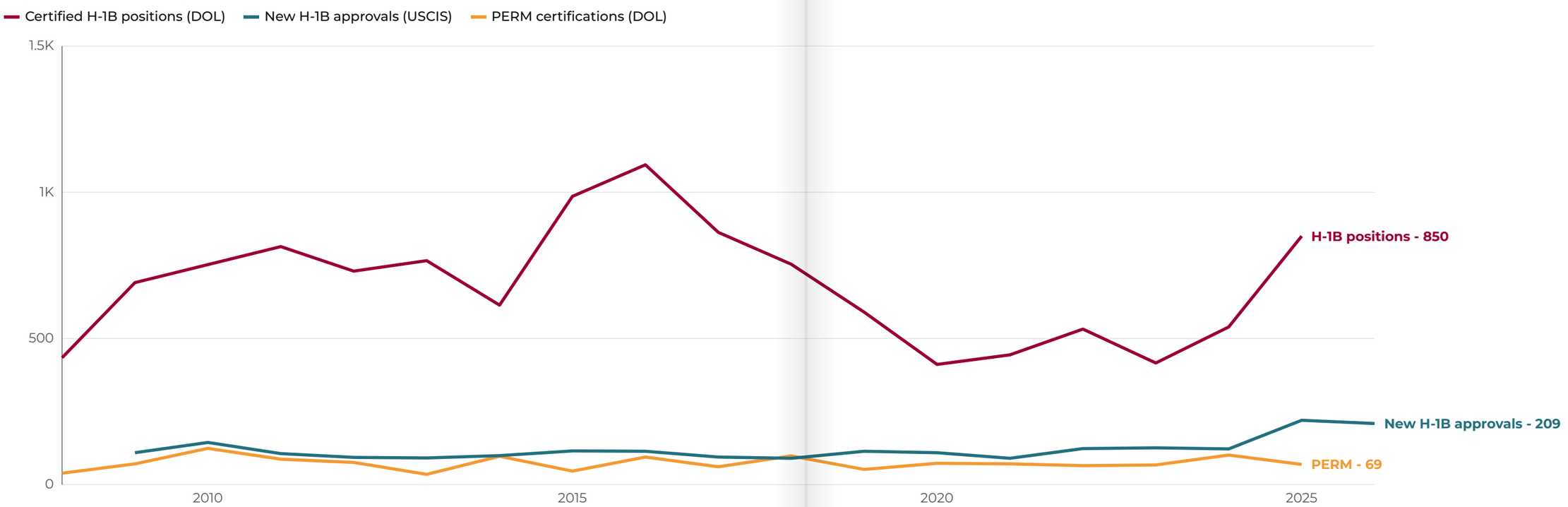
U.S. **$193B** · **44th** of 51 · +25% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on green-card labor certifications, at 69 in 2025 against 138K for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does West Virginia Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 850 H-1B positions at West Virginia worksites in FY2025, 44th of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 209 new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 69 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 13% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

850

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **44th** of 51 · −14% since 2015

69

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

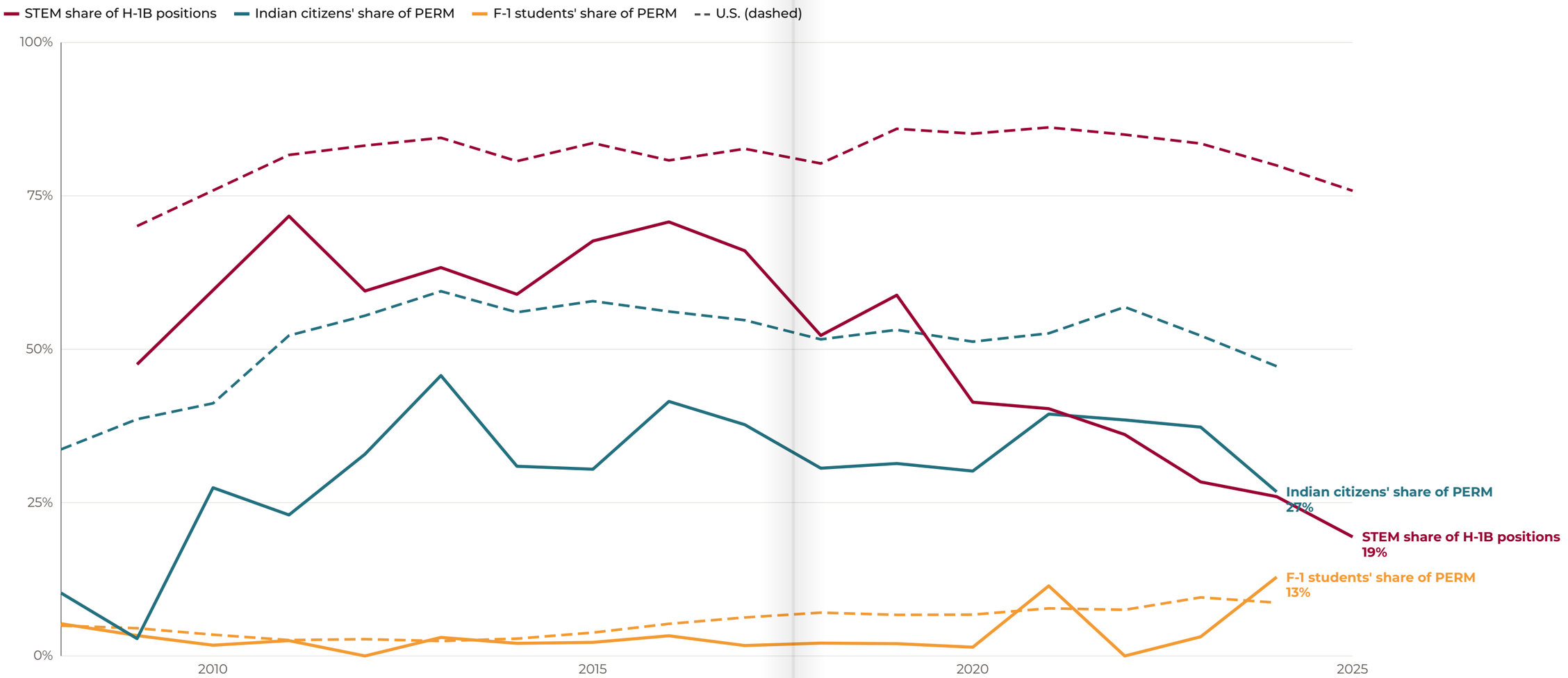
U.S. **138K** · **50th** of 51

13%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **14th** of 51 · +10.6 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds West Virginia's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

19% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 27% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

19%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **49th** of 51 · −48.2 pp since 2015

27%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **34th** of 51 · −3.7 pp since 2015

$135K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

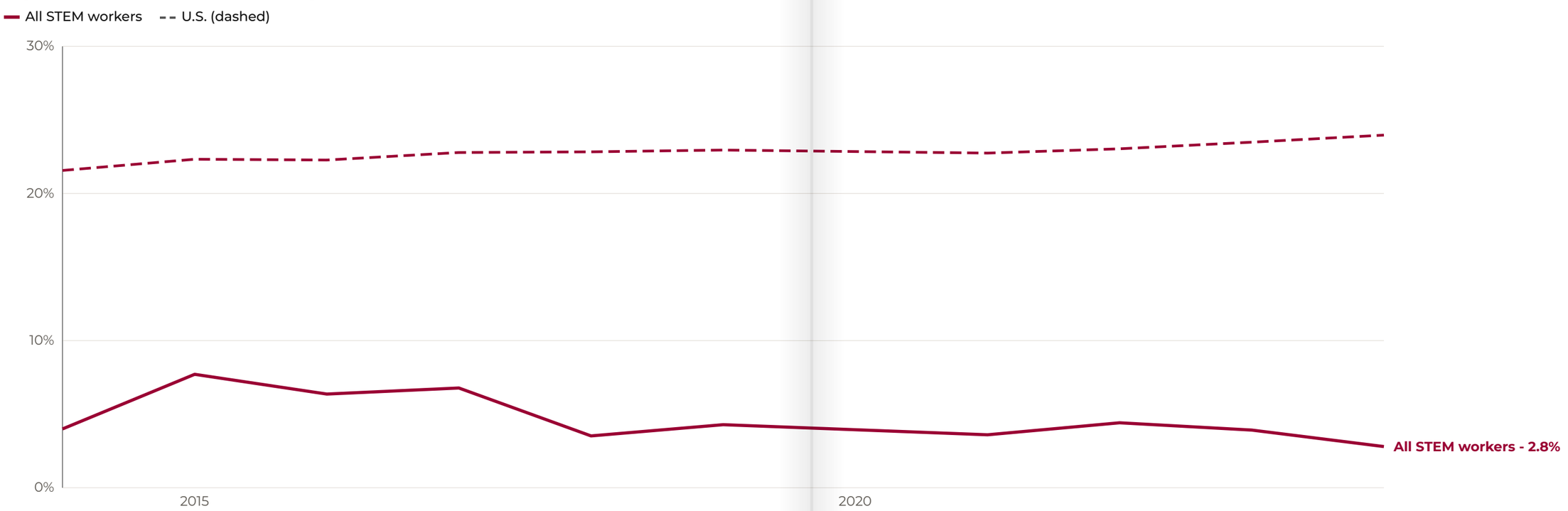
U.S. **$119K** · **3rd** of 51 · +93% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 2.8% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of West Virginia's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 2.8% of the people working in STEM occupations in West Virginia were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 50th of 51).

2.8%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **50th** of 51 · −4.9 pp since 2015

1.3%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

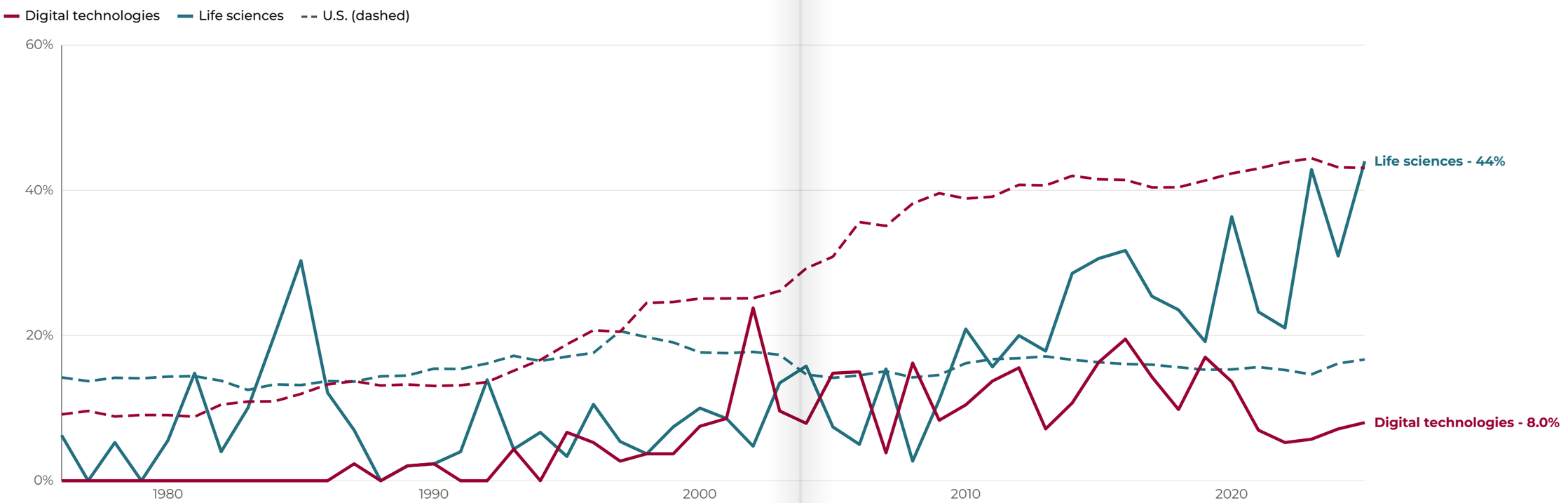
U.S. **11%** · **50th** of 51 · −4.0 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

West Virginia ranks 50th of 51 states on patents granted to assignees in the state, at 24 in 2025 against 135K for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does West Virginia Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in West Virginia were granted 24 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.0% of all patents with a U.S. owner (50th of 51).

8.0% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 44% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

24

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **50th** of 51

8.0%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **49th** of 51 · −8.3 pp since 2015

44%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

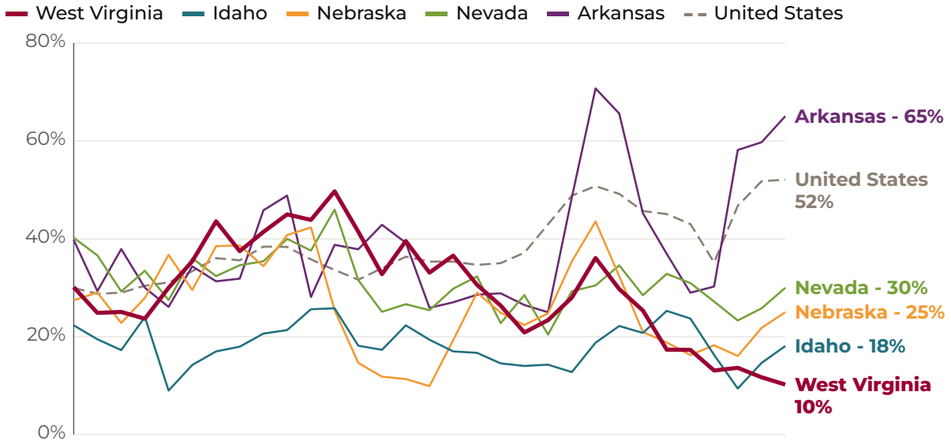
U.S. **17%** · **2nd** of 51 · +13.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in size are Idaho, Nebraska, Nevada, Arkansas. West Virginia ranks 5th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Arkansas is the most dependent at 65%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are West Virginia and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



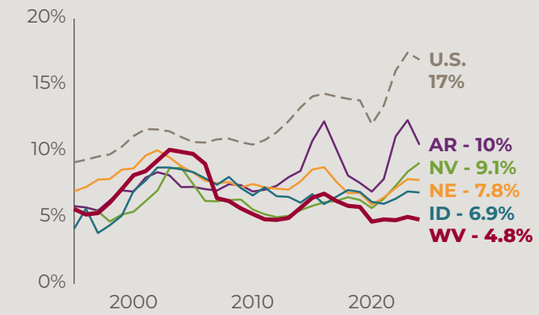
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does West Virginia Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	WV	ID	NE	NV	AR	U.S.
Students enrolled	**137K**	136K	140K	121K	162K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**16%**	7.0%	18%	10%	16%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**16%**	22%	20%	20%	17%	24%
STEM share of master's	**10%**	18%	13%	15%	22%	23%
International STEM master's	**76**	78	170	117	918	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**0.1%**	0.1%	0.1%	0.1%	0.8%	–
Int. share of STEM master's	**10%**	18%	25%	30%	65%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**43%**	32%	38%	48%	58%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**4.8%**	6.9%	7.8%	9.1%	10%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**1.7%**	2.1%	2.1%	0.8%	2.3%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**53%**	53%	61%	54%	54%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$9.14K**	$8.18K	$9.29K	$6.6K	$9.24K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$10.3K**	$11K	$14.2K	$10.8K	$9.05K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$76.4K**	$81.4K	$88.5K	$110K	$70.1K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**58%**	54%	77%	91%	70%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**+36**	+19	+2	−18	+16	–

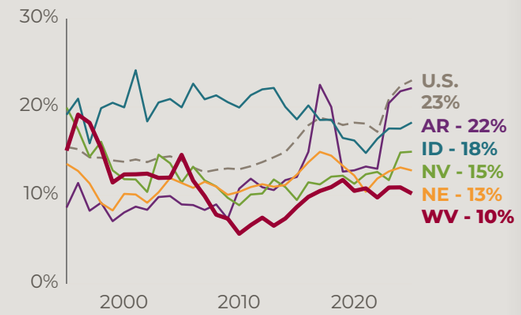
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



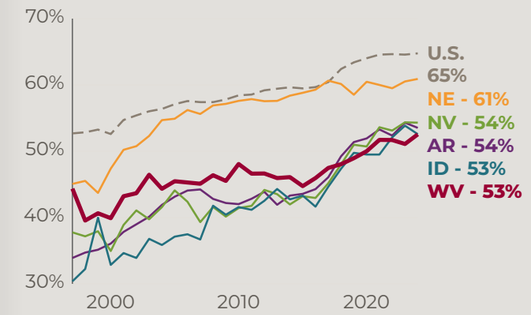
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



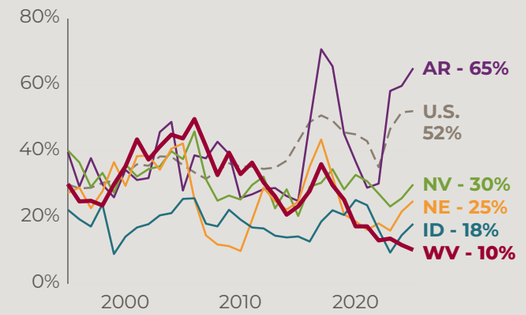
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

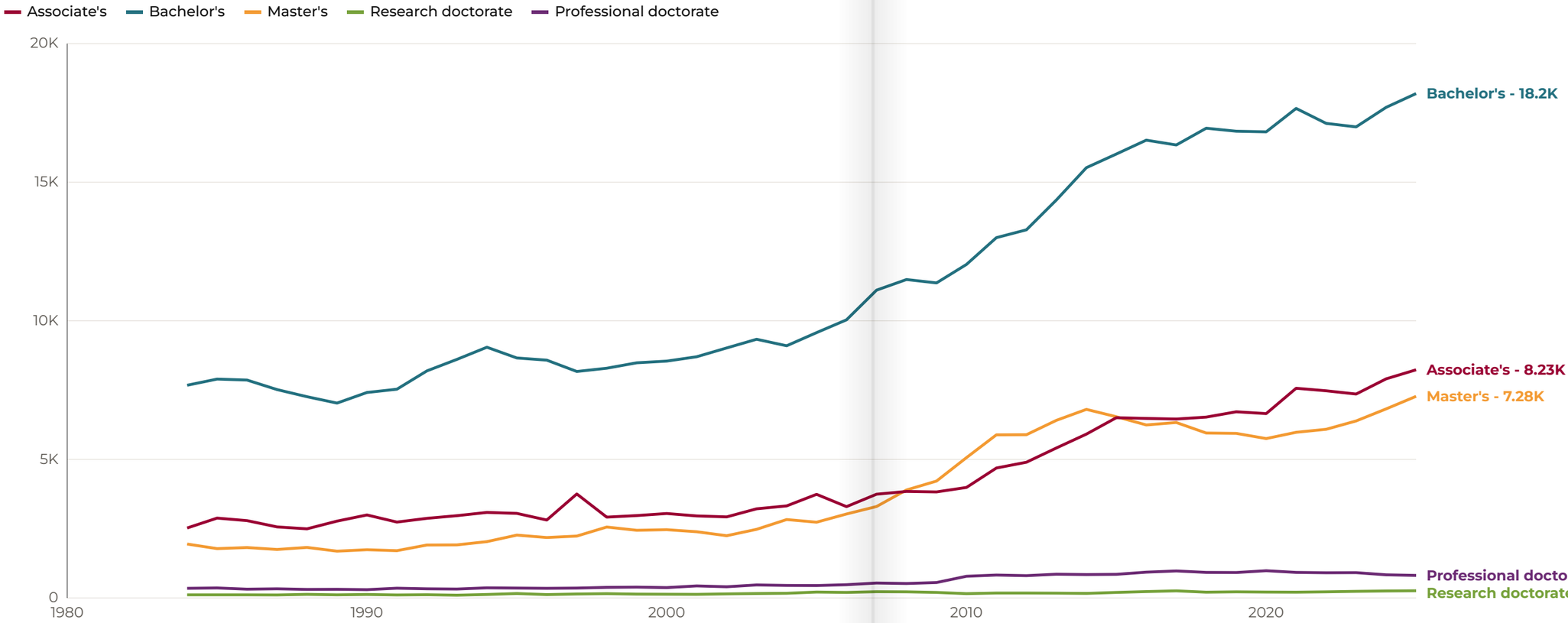


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does West Virginia Award?

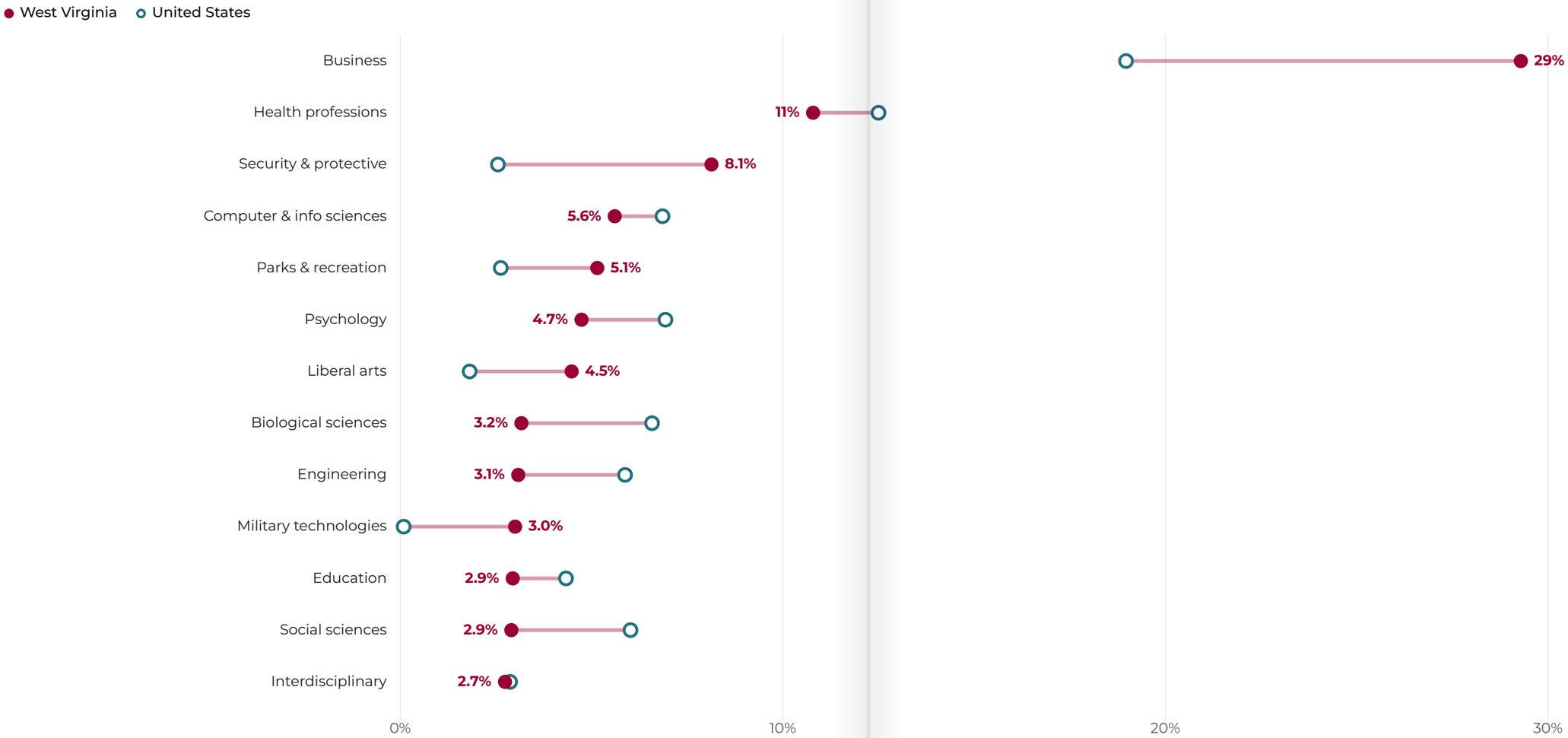


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, West Virginia's institutions awarded 8.23K associate's degrees, 18.2K bachelor's degrees, 7.28K master's degrees, 260 research doctorate degrees, 812 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's up 27%; bachelor's up 14%; master's up 11%; research doctorate up 29%; professional doctorate down 5%. The state awards 15.8 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do West Virginia's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

West Virginia's largest bachelor's fields are business (29%; U.S. 19%), health professions (11%; U.S. 13%), security & protective (8.1%; U.S. 2.6%).

Relative to the nation, West Virginia's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in military technologies (34.12× the U.S. share), security & protective (3.19× the U.S. share), liberal arts (2.47× the U.S. share).

5.6%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **27th** of 51 · +1.4 pp since 2015

4.0%
Bachelor's in engineering, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **46th** of 51 · −1.4 pp since 2015

29%
Bachelor's in business, 2025
U.S. **19%** · **2nd** of 51 · +12.0 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do West Virginia's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

West Virginia's largest master's fields are business (37%; U.S. 21%), health professions (12%; U.S. 15%), education (9.1%; U.S. 15%).

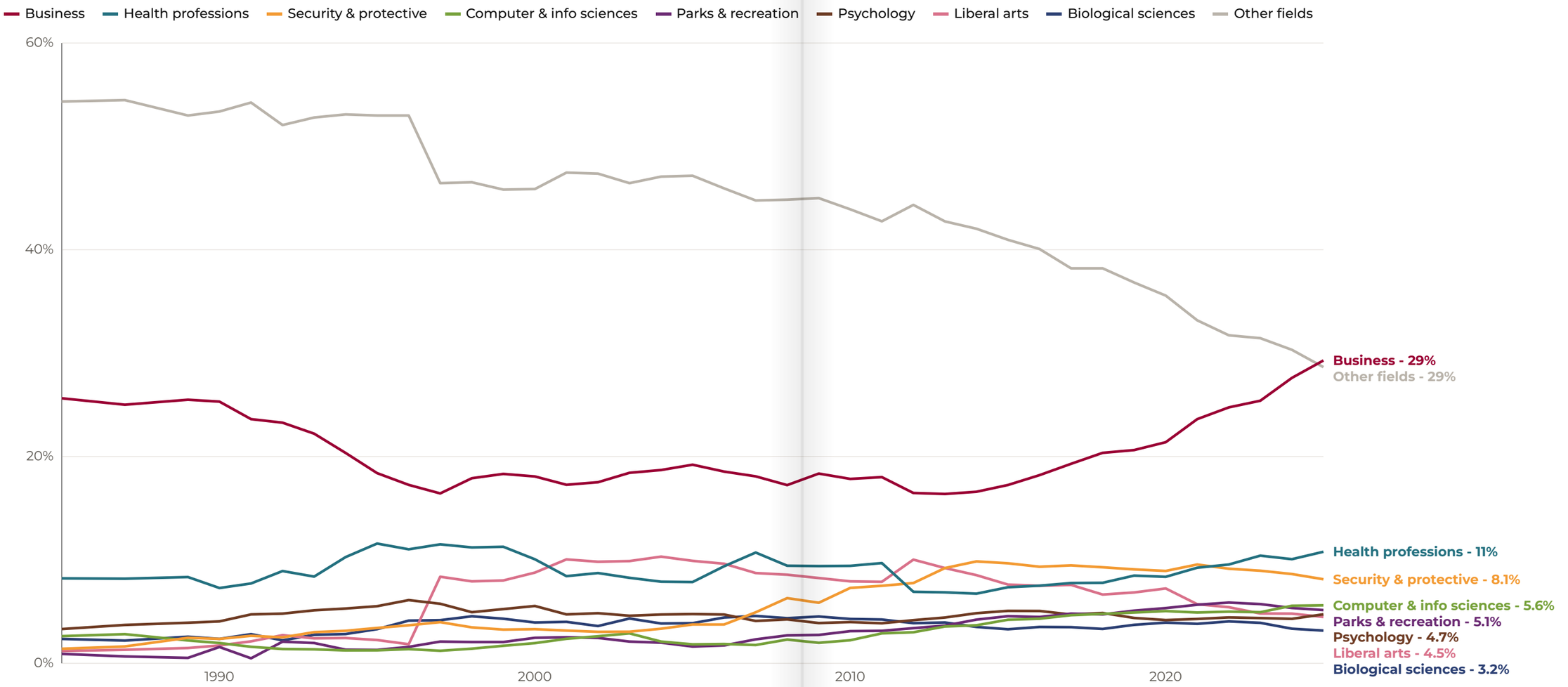
International students earn 3.7% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 10% of them.

10%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **49th** of 51 · +1.5 pp since 2015

3.7%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **50th** of 51 · −1.9 pp since 2015

8.8%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **45th** of 47 · −9.9 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has West Virginia's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, business has gained the most ground, 12.0 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while liberal arts lost the most (3.1 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is West Virginia Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of West Virginia's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Military technologies (34.12, with 3.0% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.1% for the U.S.), security & protective (3.19, with 8.1% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 2.6% for the U.S.), and liberal arts (2.47, with 4.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.8% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is West Virginia Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Military technologies	**34.12**	3.0%	0.1%	546
Security & protective	**3.19**	8.1%	2.6%	1.48K
Liberal arts	**2.47**	4.5%	1.8%	815
Natural resources	**2.35**	2.6%	1.1%	478
Parks & recreation	**1.96**	5.1%	2.6%	937
Business	**1.54**	29%	19%	5.33K
History	**1.08**	1.1%	1.0%	202
Engineering technology	**1.01**	0.9%	0.9%	165
Agriculture	**0.98**	1.0%	1.0%	184
Interdisciplinary	**0.95**	2.7%	2.9%	498

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

16%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **50th** of 51

5.6%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **27th** of 51

4.0%
Bachelor's in engineering, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **46th** of 51

29%
Bachelor's in business, 2025
U.S. **19%** · **2nd** of 51

Engineering. The share was 4.0% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 46th among the states, down 0.6 points from 4.6% in 2024 and down 1.4 points since 2015, when it was 5.4%.

Health professions. The share was 11% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 31st among the states, up 0.7 points from 10% in 2024 and up 3.4 points since 2015, when it was 7.4%.

Table 6 West Virginia at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	17% 2024	**16% 2025**	−0.5 pp	24%	50th
Bachelor's in computer science	4.2%	5.6% 2024	**5.6% 2025**	+1.4 pp	6.9%	27th
Bachelor's in engineering	5.4%	4.6% 2024	**4.0% 2025**	−1.4 pp	6.8%	46th
Bachelor's in business	17%	28% 2024	**29% 2025**	+12.0 pp	19%	2nd

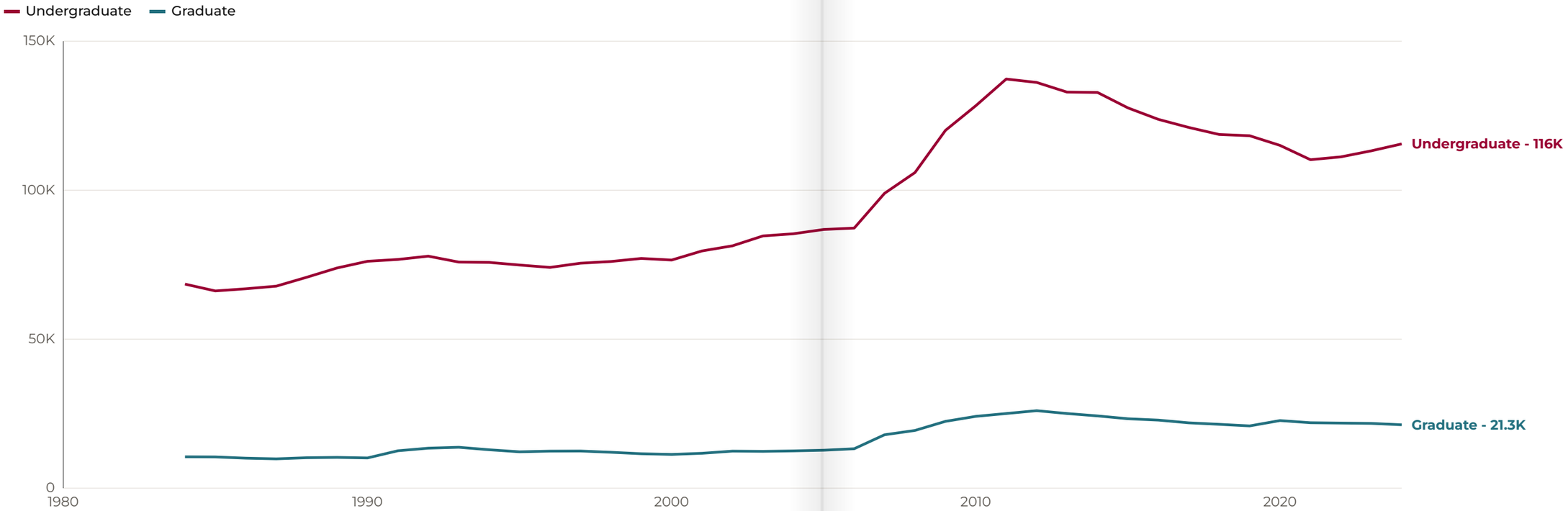
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

West Virginia ranks 4th of 51 states on the share of students enrolled part-time, at 51% in 2024 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, West Virginia enrolled 116K undergraduates and 21.3K graduate students, 137K in all (37th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 9% since 2015 and graduate enrollment down 9% since 2015. Graduate students are 16% of all students (U.S. 17%).

137K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **37th** of 51 · −9.3% since 2015

16%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **26th** of 51 · +0.1 pp since 2015

51%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **4th** of 51 · +2.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in West Virginia, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at West Virginia's degree-granting institutions, **65%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 7.1 points since 2015.

Black students were **11%** (U.S. 12%), up 0.3 points since 2015, and Hispanic students were **9.6%** (U.S. 21%), up 4.5 points since 2015.

Students of two or more races were **4.3%** (U.S. 4.2%), up 1.5 points since 2015, and Asian and Pacific Islander students were **2.5%** (U.S. 7.4%), up 0.6 points since 2015. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in West Virginia?

West Virginia · United States

		Change since 2015
White	65% · U.S. 45%	−7.1 pts
Black	11% · U.S. 12%	+0.3 pts
Hispanic	9.6% · U.S. 21%	+4.5 pts
Two or more	4.3% · U.S. 4.2%	+1.5 pts
Asian / Pacific Islander	2.5% · U.S. 7.4%	+0.6 pts
International	2.2% · U.S. 5.3%	−0.6 pts
American Indian	0.4% · U.S. 0.6%	+0.0 pts

Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

65% White students · U.S. **45%** · −7.1 pp since 2015

11% Black students · U.S. **12%** · +0.3 pp since 2015

43% At public 4-year institutions · −2.2 pp since 2015

41% At for-profit institutions · +4.4 pp since 2015

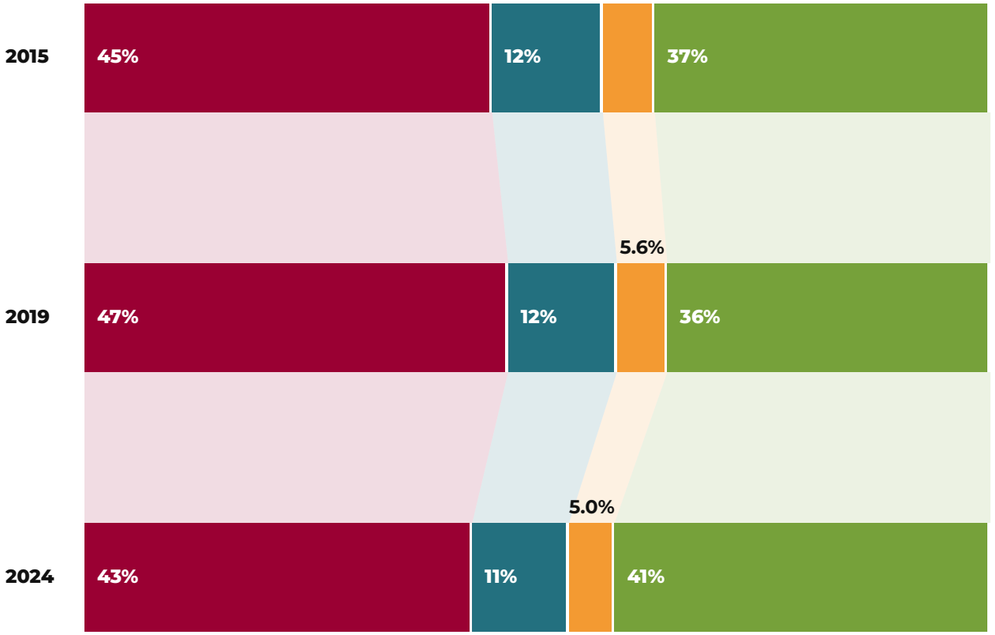
In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **43%** of students, down 2.2 points from 45% in 2015. For-profit institutions enrolled **41%** of students, up 4.4 points from 37% in 2015.

Public 2-year institutions enrolled **11%** of students, down 1.5 points from 12% in 2015, and private nonprofit institutions enrolled **5.0%** of students, down 0.7 points from 5.7% in 2015.

Public institutions together enrolled **53%** of students, against 73% nationally, 44th among the states.

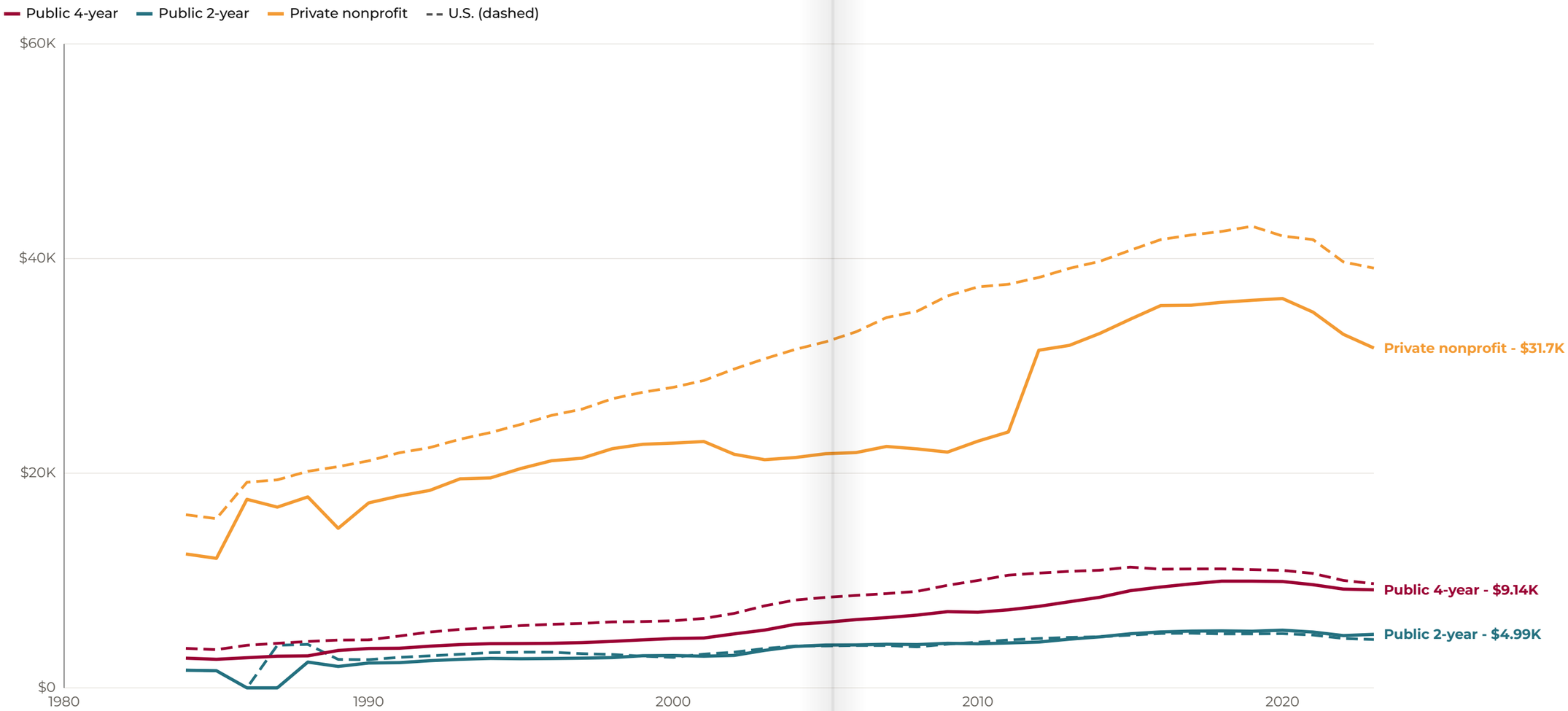
Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?

Public 4-year · Public 2-year · Private nonprofit · For-profit



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at West Virginia's public four-year institutions are $9.14K (2023, 2024 dollars), 6% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 35th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $10.3K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (31st of 51), and tuition makes up 52% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).

$9.14K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **35th** of 51 · +0.9% since 2015

$10.3K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **31st** of 51 · +36% since 2015

52%

Tuition share of public revenue, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **16th** of 51 · −7.6 pp since 2015

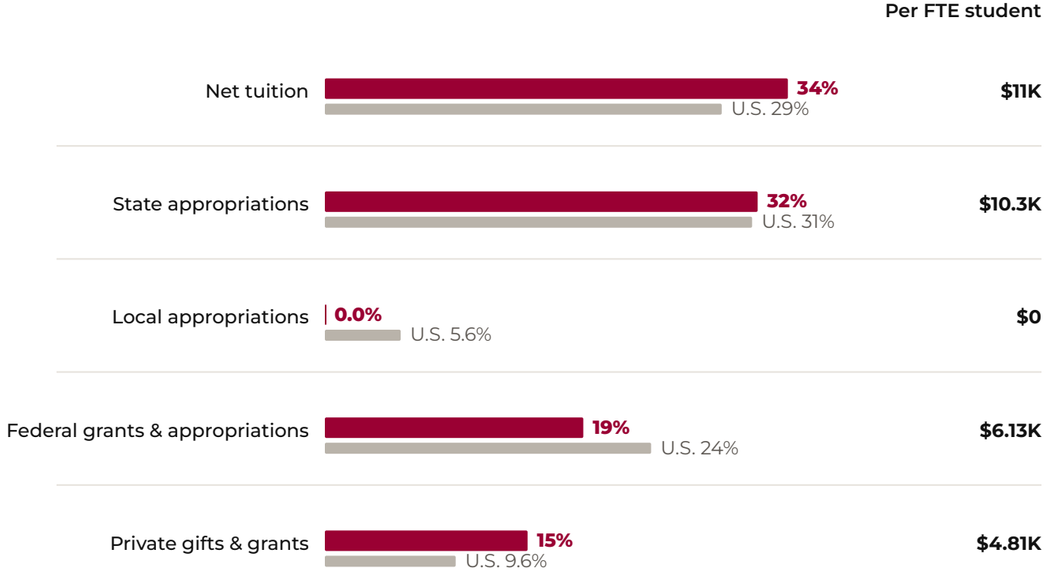
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are West Virginia's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of West Virginia's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $11K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 2.7% from $11.3K in FY2023 and up 0.2% since FY2015, when it was $11K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$9.14K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **35th** of 51

$10.3K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **31st** of 51

52%
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **16th** of 51

53%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **48th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in West Virginia: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $9.14K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 35th among the states, down 0.8% from $9.21K in 2022 and up 0.9% since 2015, when it was $9.05K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	West Virginia	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$9.14K**	$9.71K	35th of 51	+0.9%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$10.3K**	$11.4K	31st of 51	+36%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**52%**	43%	16th of 51	−7.6 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**53%**	65%	48th of 51	+7.8 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$76.4K**	$106K	49th of 51	−9.4%

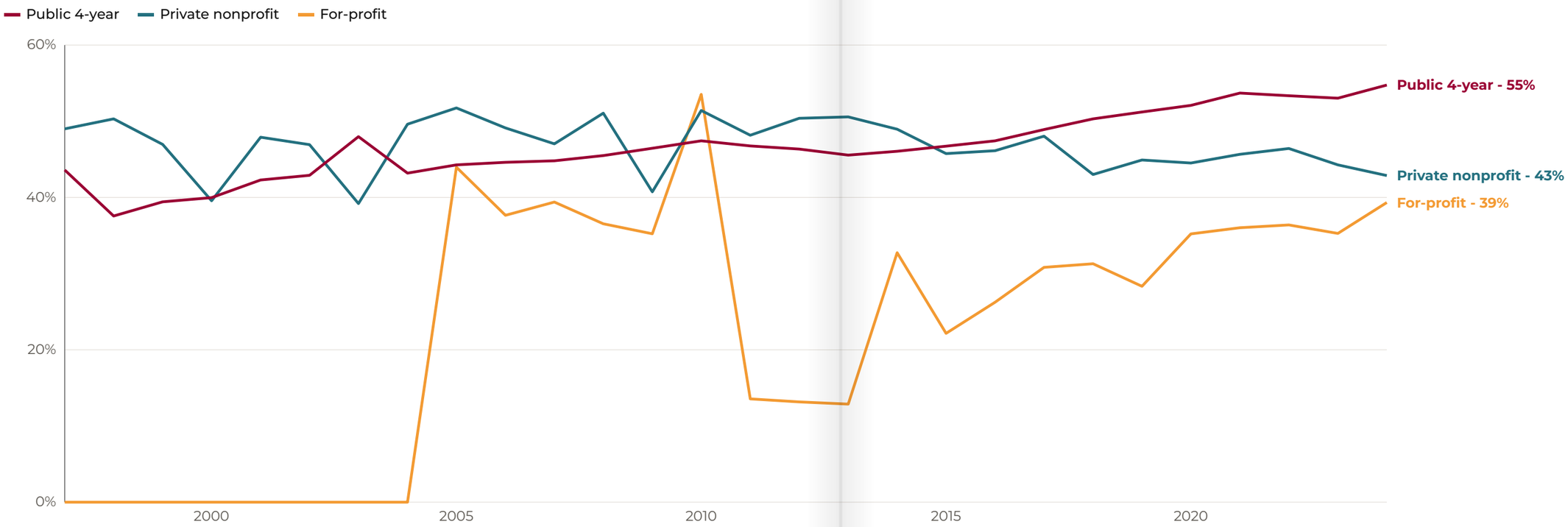
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

West Virginia ranks 48th of 51 states on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 53% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

53% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in West Virginia graduated within six years (2024), 12.2 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 48th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 55%, private nonprofit 43%, for-profit 39%. At two-year institutions, 34% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

53%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **48th** of 51 · +7.8 pp since 2015

34%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **36th** of 50 · +11.8 pp since 2015

15.8
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **7th** of 51 · +3.7 since 2015

SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

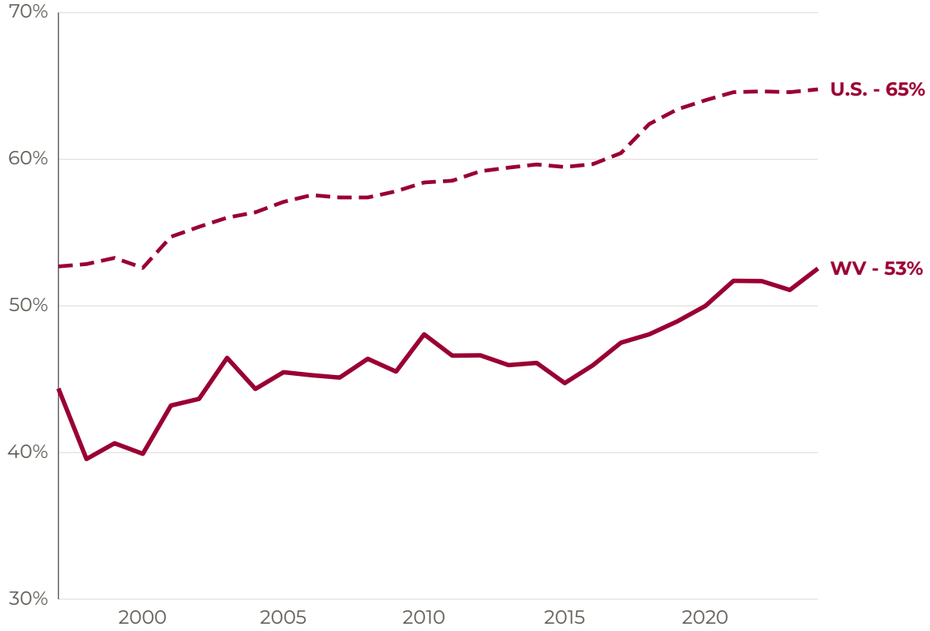
How Many of West Virginia's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at West Virginia's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 53% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 1.5 points from 51% in 2023 and up 7.8 points since 2015, when it was 45%.

Public 4-year institutions. The rate was 55% in 2024, up 1.7 points from 53% in 2023 and up 8.0 points since 2015, when it was 47%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

53%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **48th** of 51

34%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **36th** of 50

15.8
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **7th** of 51

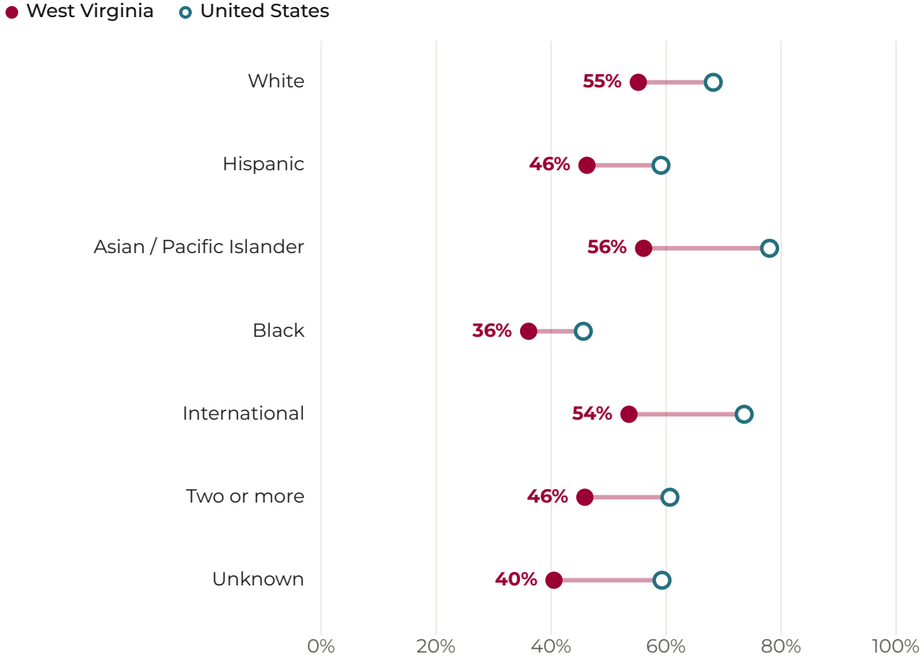
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at West Virginia's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 55% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 46% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 56% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



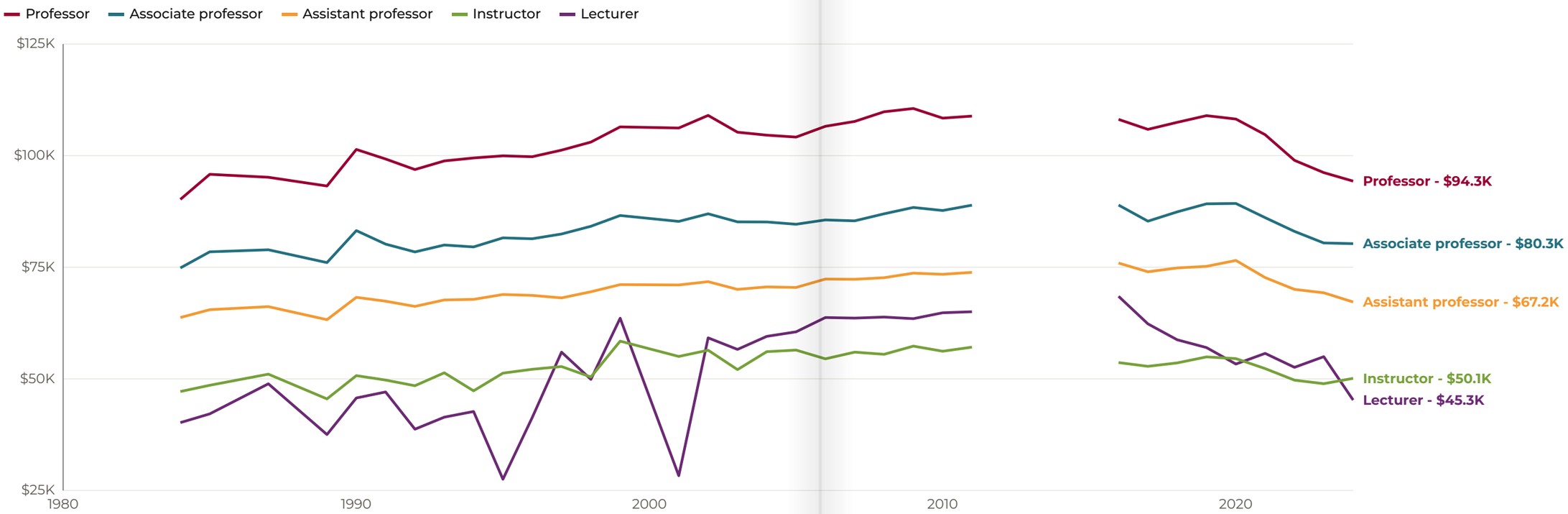
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

West Virginia ranks 49th of 51 states on the average full-time faculty salary, at $76.4K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do West Virginia's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at West Virginia's institutions earned an average of $76.4K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 28% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 49th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $94.3K, associate professors $80.3K, assistant professors $67.2K, instructors $50.1K, lecturers $45.3K.

West Virginia's institutions had 4.22K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 20% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 9% since 2016.

$76.4K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **49th** of 51 · −9.4% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

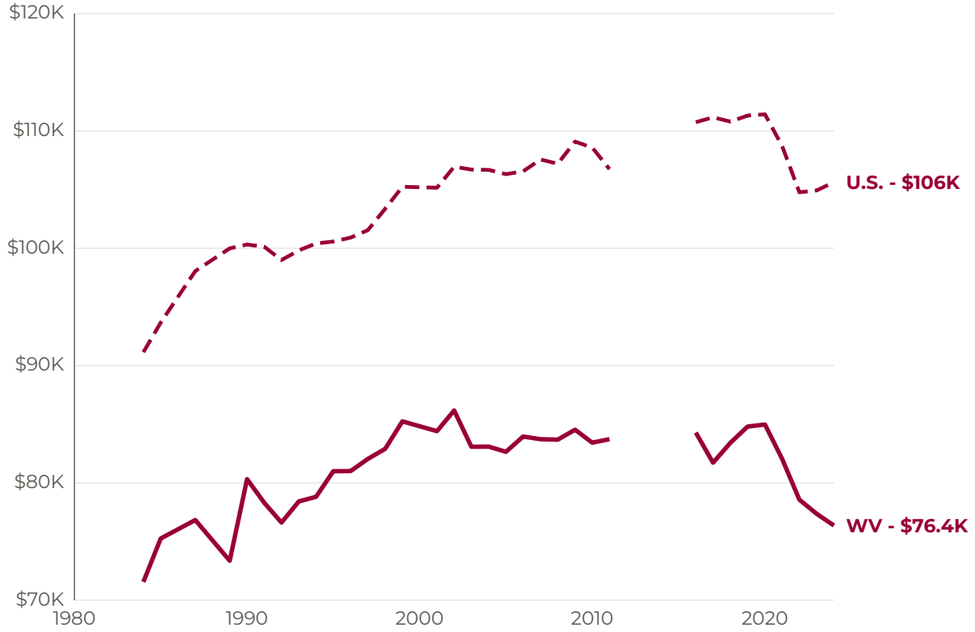
What Do West Virginia's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at West Virginia's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $76.4K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 49th among the states, down 1.3% from $77.4K in 2023 and down 9.4% since 2016, when it was $84.3K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 4.22K in 2024, down 4.9% from 4.43K in 2023 and down 20% since 2015, when it was 5.24K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$76.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **49th** of 51

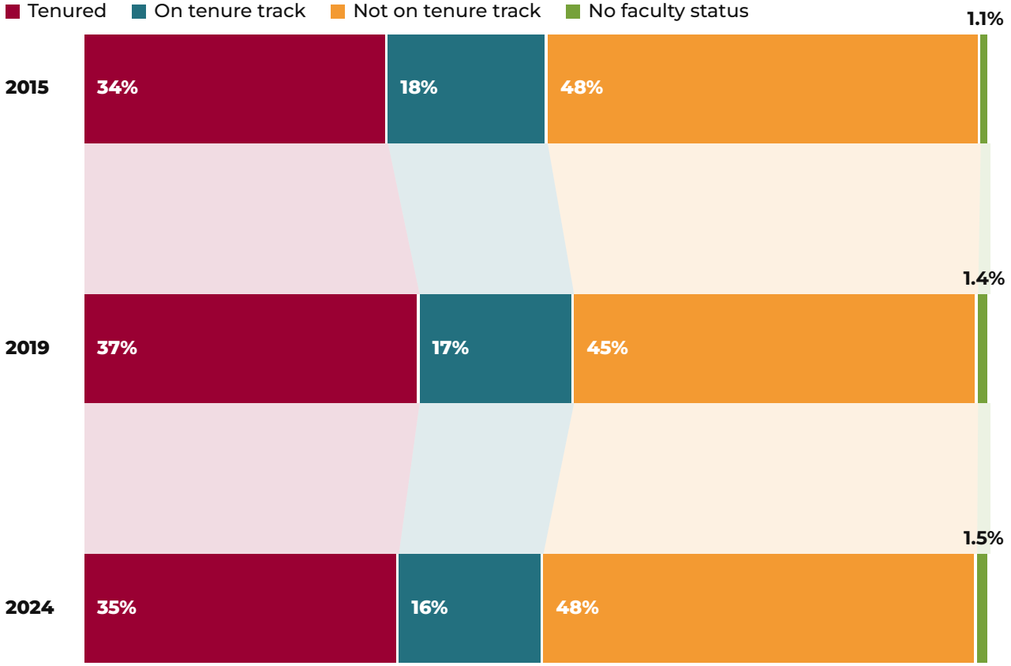
4.22K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

35%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide West Virginia's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 35% in 2024, down 0.5 points from 35% in 2023 and up 1.2 points since 2015, when it was 34%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



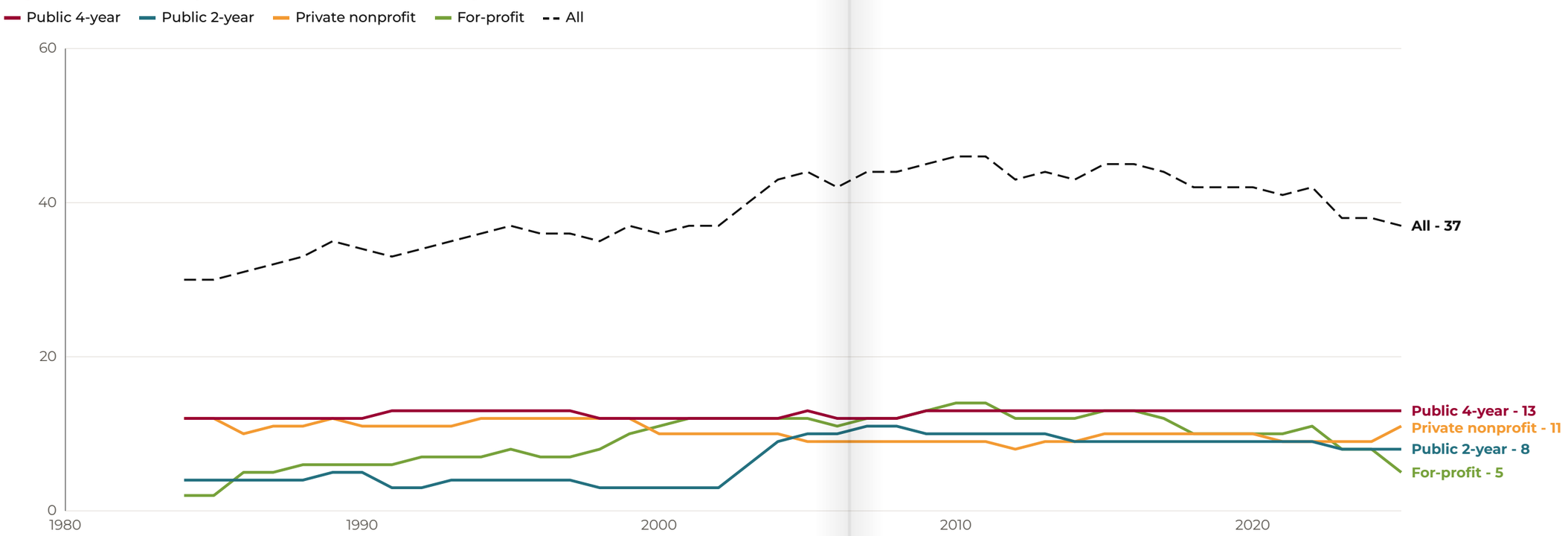
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

West Virginia ranks 1st of 51 states on the share of enrollment at for-profit institutions, at 41% in 2024 against 5.5% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does West Virginia Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

West Virginia has 37 degree-granting institutions:13 public 4-year, 8 public 2-year, 11 private nonprofit, 5 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 18% since 2015. 53% of students attend public institutions and 41% attend for-profit ones.

53%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **44th** of 51 · −3.7 pp since 2015

41%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **1st** of 51 · +4.4 pp since 2015

52%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **4th** of 51 · +11.0 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in West Virginia?

The table ranks institutions in West Virginia by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. West Virginia University (50 international STEM master's degrees and 50 doctorates), Marshall University (10 international STEM master's degrees and – doctorates), and American Public University System (8 international STEM master's degrees and – doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 8 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
West Virginia University Morgantown · Public 4-year	**50**	24%	50	44%
Marshall University Huntington · Public 4-year	**10**	15%	–	–%
American Public University System Charles Town · For-profit	**8**	2.0%	–	–
West Virginia State University Institute · Public 4-year	**4**	27%	–	–
Salem University Salem · For-profit	**3**	60%	–	–
Shepherd University Shepherdstown · Public 4-year	**1**	100%	–	–

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

37
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

53%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **44th** of 51

41%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **1st** of 51

52%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **4th** of 51

The table lists West Virginia's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were American Public University System (50.7K students), West Virginia University (23.6K students), and Marshall University (12K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 37 in 2025, and 37 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 9 What Are West Virginia's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
American Public University System	**50.7K**	1.3%	1.2K	47%	–
West Virginia University	**23.6K**	12%	1.02K	64%	89%
Marshall University	**12K**	3.7%	246	51%	96%
Blue Ridge Community and Technical College	**4.2K**	–	–	–	–
Shepherd University	**3.34K**	1.3%	75	51%	97%
Fairmont State University	**3.31K**	0.5%	90	44%	99%
West Virginia State University	**3.25K**	17%	36	39%	96%
University of Charleston	**3.06K**	4.8%	23	44%	62%
West Virginia University at Parkersburg	**2.73K**	–	6	–	–
West Liberty University	**2.3K**	4.4%	39	56%	97%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

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West Virginia – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	271	**261**[2024]	−10.7 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#50	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	21%	**18%**[2024]	−2.8 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#49	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	235	**232**[2024]	−3.7 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#46	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	33%	**31%**[2024]	−1.4 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#48	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	260	**247**[2024]	−12.8 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#49	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	27%	**21%**[2024]	−6.5 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#49	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	216	**206**[2024]	−10.4 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#49	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**150**[2015]	–	153	–	#36	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$15.1K	**$15.6K**[2021]	+3.7% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#27	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	87%	**91%**[2022]	+4.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#1	[3]
Public high school graduates	17.7K	**16.2K**[2024]	−8.7% ▼	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#39	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$59.9K	**$55.2K**[2022]	−7.8% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#49	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	14.1	**13.5**[2022]	−0.6 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#35	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	277K	**242K**[2024]	−13% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#39	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	46%	**52%**[2023]	+5.4 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#21	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	1.0%	**0.8%**[2022]	−0.2 pp ▼	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#51	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	0.0%	**0.5%**[2023]	+0.5 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#41	[3]
High schools offering calculus	69%[2016]	**56%**[2024]	−13.3 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#20	[14]
High schools offering physics	74%[2016]	**54%**[2024]	−19.9 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#37	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	87%[2016]	**82%**[2024]	−4.9 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#26	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	80%[2016]	**91%**[2024]	+10.4 pp ▲	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#22	[14]
High schools offering computer science	48%[2021]	**67%**[2024]	+18.4 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#19	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	80%[2016]	**74%**[2024]	−6.2 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#11	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	25%[2021]	**34%**[2024]	+9.4 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#14	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	64%[2016]	**88%[2024]**	+23.7 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#4	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	12.7[2016]	**9.9[2024]**	−2.8 ▼	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#49	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	2.6[2016]	**1.4[2024]**	−1.2 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#46	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	2.9[2016]	**1.6[2024]**	−1.4 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#51	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	16.4[2016]	**21.5[2024]**	+5.1 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#20	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	2.0[2016]	**1.8[2024]**	−0.3 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#42	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	37%	**34%[2025]**	−2.6 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#27	[15]
Fall enrollment	151K	**137K[2024]**	−9.3% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#37	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	57%	**53%[2024]**	−3.7 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#44	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	37%	**41%[2024]**	+4.4 pp ▲	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#1	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	49%	**51%[2024]**	+2.5 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#4	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	15%	**16%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	41%	**52%[2024]**	+11.0 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#4	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	217	**231[2025]**	+6.5% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#41	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	140	**153[2025]**	+9.3% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#43	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.4%	**0.4%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#41	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	37	**33[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#42	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	9	**4[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#49	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	6.1	**6.4[2025]**	+0.3 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#20	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	17%	**16%[2025]**	−0.5 pp ▼	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	4.2%	**5.6%[2025]**	+1.4 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#27	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	5.4%	**4.0%[2025]**	−1.4 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#46	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.4%	**0.4%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#50	[4]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	3.3%	**3.2%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.3%	**0.6%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#50	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	7.4%	**11%**[2025]	+3.4 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	17%	**29%**[2025]	+12.0 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#2	[4]
STEM share of master's	8.7%	**10%**[2025]	+1.5 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.0%	**4.4%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#40	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	3.0%	**2.5%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#45	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.2%**[2025]	−0.5 pp ▼	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	0.7%	**1.1%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	0.5%	**0.3%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#48	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	8.6%	**12%**[2025]	+3.6 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#37	[4]
Share of master's in business	22%	**37%**[2025]	+14.3 pp ▲	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#3	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	46%	**45%**[2025]	−1.7 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#22	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.5%	**0.8%**[2025]	−2.7 pp ▼	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	20%	**13%**[2025]	−7.2 pp ▼	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#26	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	0.0%	**1.2%**[2025]	+1.2 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#38	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	8.5%	**14%**[2025]	+5.8 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#11	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.5%	**13%**[2025]	+5.0 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#4	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	9.0%	**4.6%**[2025]	−4.3 pp ▼	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	2.0%	**8.8%**[2025]	+6.9 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#11	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	12.1	**15.8**[2025]	+3.7 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#7	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	1.9%[2016]	**1.9%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#36	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	133	**76**[2025]	−43% ▼	117K	2.18× ▲	#45	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.2%	**0.1%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#45	[4]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	2.1%	**1.7%**[2024]	−0.4 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#41	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	6.5%	**4.8%**[2024]	−1.6 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#49	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	2.1%	**2.3%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#42	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	4.4%	**3.4%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of all master's	5.6%	**3.7%**[2025]	−1.9 pp ▼	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#50	[4]
International share of STEM master's	23%	**10%**[2025]	−13.1 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#48	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	19%	**8.8%**[2025]	−9.9 pp ▼	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#45	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	35%	**15%**[2025]	−19.4 pp ▼	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#50	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	58%	**49%**[2019]	−9.6 pp ▼	58%	+9.6 pp ▲	#19	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	13%	**2.4%**[2025]	−10.9 pp ▼	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#47	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	15%	**17%**[2024]	+1.5 pp ▲	29%	−0.2 pp ▼	#36	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	27%	**29%**[2025]	+1.9 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#17	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	41%	**43%**[2025]	+2.2 pp ▲	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#22	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	60%	**64%**[2025]	+3.6 pp ▲	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#7	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	23%[2020]	**22%**[2025]	−1.7 pp ▼	23%	−2.4 pp ▼	#27	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	53%[2017]	**46%**[2025]	−7.6 pp ▼	38%	−0.9 pp ▼	#8	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	4.26K	**2.48K**[2026]	−42% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#45	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	**0.2%**[2026]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#45	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	9.4%	**7.3%**[2026]	−2.1 pp ▼	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#44	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	14%	**3.4%**[2026]	−10.5 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#46	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	32%	**16%**[2026]	−16.7 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#51	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	146	**138**[2026]	−5.5% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#42	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	1.95K	**1.01K**[2026]	−48% ▼	749K	+61% ▲	#46	[20]
Active STEM master's students	429	**278**[2026]	−35% ▼	393K	+90% ▲	#46	[20]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Active STEM doctoral students	407	**347**[2026]	−15% ▼	158K	+61% ▲	#45	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	47%	**35%**[2026]	−11.8 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#43	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	1.05K[2017]	**754**[2024]	−28% ▼	–	–	#43	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	$132M[2018]	**$81.9M**[2024]	−38% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#44	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	1.25K[2018]	**529**[2024]	−58% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#44	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#49	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#47	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#47	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.25K	**1.32K**[2025]	+5.2% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#43	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	2.13K	**2.06K**[2016]	−3.6% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#40	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	763	**768**[2016]	+0.7% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#40	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	36%	**37%**[2016]	+1.6 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#19	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	54%	**56%**[2016]	+2.5 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#21	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	52	**62**[2016]	+19% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#47	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	29%	**61%**[2016]	+32.4 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#13	[9]
University R&D spending	$199M	**$306M**[2024]	+54% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#45	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.3%	**0.3%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#45	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	43%	**51%**[2024]	+7.3 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#31	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	6.4%	**2.1%**[2024]	−4.3 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#42	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	7.2%	**4.4%**[2024]	−2.9 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#31	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	$1.71M	**$3.44M**[2024]	2.00× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#50	[6]
University R&D in engineering	$36.9M	**$59.2M**[2024]	+60% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#42	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	4.15K	**4.36K**[2024]	+4.9% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#41	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	$239M	**$298M**[2024]	+25% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#44	[8]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	$33.9M	**$94.2M[2024]**	2.78× ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#46	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	$19M	**$116M[2024]**	6.13× ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#38	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	$53M	**$75.4M[2024]**	+42% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#42	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	$37.3M	**$75.8M[2025]**	2.03× ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#49	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	$15.9M	**$39.5M[2026]**	+23.6 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#35	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$43K[2020]	**$44K[2022]**	+2.4% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#38	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$47.9K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#29	[15]
Median debt of completers	$18.6K	**$18.3K[2024]**	−1.7% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#41	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$68.5K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#20	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$56K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#10	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$65.7K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#30	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$86.6K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#25	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	45%	**53%[2024]**	+7.8 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	22%	**34%[2024]**	+11.8 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#36	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$9.05K	**$9.14K[2023]**	+0.9% ▲	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#35	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$7.53K	**$10.3K[2024]**	+36% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#31	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	59%	**52%[2024]**	−7.6 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#16	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$84.3K[2016]	**$76.4K[2024]**	−9.4% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#49	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	21%	**20%[2016]**	−0.7 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#47	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	27%	**27%[2016]**	+0.2 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#48	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	15%	**13%[2016]**	−2.1 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#46	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	19%	**15%[2016]**	−3.4 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#47	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.58	**0.40[2016]**	−0.2 ▼	1.00	0.0	#48	[21]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	75	**72**[2016]	−4.0% ▼	41.2K	+51% ▲	#43	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	49%[2016]	**50%**[2019]	+1.0 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#30	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**39%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#33	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**39%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#31	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	36%[2016]	**38%**[2019]	+1.3 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#30	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**55%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#26	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**39%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#29	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$42.6K[2016]	**$42.9K**[2019]	+0.7% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#32	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$61.5K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#30	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$59.3K[2016]	**$55.9K**[2019]	−5.7% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#22	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−19.4	**+10.2**[2025]	+29.6 ▲	–	–	#5	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−2.22K	**+374**[2025]	+2,595.0 ▲	–	–	#23	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	2.5%	**3.6%**[2025]	+1.1 pp ▲	–	–	#13	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.4%	**2.5%**[2025]	−1.9 pp ▼	–	–	#30	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	938	**561**[2025]	−40% ▼	–	–	#50	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	61%[2016]	**58%**[2024]	−2.9 pp ▼	–	–	#44	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+40[2016]	**+36**[2024]	−3.7 ▼	–	–	#7	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	11%[2016]	**14%**[2022]	+2.7 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#47	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	986	**850**[2025]	−14% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#44	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.1%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#44	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	68%	**19%**[2025]	−48.2 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#49	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$70K	**$135K**[2025]	+93% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#3	[17]

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WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	32%	**4.5%**[2025]	−27.1 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#46	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	46	**69**[2025]	–	138K	+75% ▲	#50	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	30%	**27%**[2024]	−3.7 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#34	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	2.2%	**13%**[2024]	+10.6 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#14	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	37%	**23%**[2024]	−14.4 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#37	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	18%	**22%**[2025]	+3.3 pp ▲	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#41	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$93K	**$82.8K**[2025]	−11% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#28	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	786	**820**[2024]	+4.3% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#48	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#48	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	501	**540**[2024]	+7.8% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#49	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#48	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.0%[2016]	**0.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	115	**209**[2026]	+82% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#41	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	116	**193**[2026]	+66% ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#44	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.2%**[2026]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#41	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	2.5%	**4.6%**[2026]	+2.0 pp ▲	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#9	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	43%	**27%**[2026]	−16.2 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#14	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	7.8%	**4.8%**[2026]	−3.0 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#51	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	50%	**73%**[2026]	+23.2 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#2	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	32.1K	**39.6K**[2024]	+24% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#44	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

WEST VIRGINIA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
STEM workers as a share of all workers	4.3%	**5.1%**[2024]	+0.8 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#50	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	7.7%	**2.8%**[2024]	−4.9 pp ▼	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#50	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	5.3%	**1.3%**[2024]	−4.0 pp ▼	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#50	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	3.9%	**1.1%**[2024]	−2.8 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#49	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	1.6%	**2.3%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#51	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	7.3%	**6.2%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#50	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	25.4K	**33.1K**[2025]	+30% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#42	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.60	**0.71**[2025]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#45	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$66.3K	**$92.1K**[2025]	+39% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#46	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$81.6K[2019]	**$121K**[2025]	+48% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#37	[10]
Software developer jobs	1.45K	**2.65K**[2025]	+83% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#43	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$39.1K	**$56.5K**[2025]	+44% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#49	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	49	**24**[2025]	–	135K	−0.6% ▼	#50	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	16%	**8.0%**[2025]	−8.3 pp ▼	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#49	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	31%	**44%**[2025]	+13.4 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#2	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	2.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	−2.0 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	12%	**11%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#35	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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